GUIDE TO ENTER THE MARKET PLACE

THE ECOMMERCE STARTUP THAT SELLS

Proven Strategies for Online Sales Success



BY REITUMETSE SETHABELA

Table of contents

Introduction

1. Getting Started
    - Business Model
    - Niche
    - Service/Product
    - Target Audience
    - Website (Landing page, Blog, Commercial site & etc.)
    - Pricing
    - Methods of Payment
    - MVP
    - Client Contract
    - Independent Trader Contract
    - Finding an Independent Trader (Contractor)
    - Copywriting
        - AIDA
        - PAS
        - FAB
        - 4P's
    - Generating Leads
    - Funnel
    - Sales
    - Email List
        - Getting It Delivered
        - Getting It Opened
        - Provide Value
2. Content Creation Strategies
    - Video
    - Blog
    - Social Media Growth
    - SEO
    - Getting Featured
3. Why people buy
    - 3 Primal Desires
    - 6 Human Needs
    - Solve Problems Within A Market Gap
    - Sell To A Hungry Audience
    - Product vs Distribution vs Ecosystem
    - Do What's Required Not Your Best
    - Market Value Needs
    - Trust And Customer Referral
4. Pre-Launch Essentials

    - Policies
    - Process
    - System
    - Standard Operating Procedures
5. 5 Essential SOPs
6. Getting The Wheel Turning
    - Marketing Business/Agency
        - Finding a Client
        - How to Sell & Close The Client
    - Execution and Maintenance
        - Processing Brand Material
        - Strategies and Tactics (Planning Board)
        - Budget Management
        - Gaining Access To Ad Accounts
        - Checking in on Independent Trader (Contractor)
        - Discussing Ups/Downs & Methods of Improvement (Contractor)
        - Discussing Ups/Downs & Methods of Improvement (Client)
        - Modifying Product or Service to Address The Issue
        - Review and Repeat
    - Closing Trade
        - Pay Contractor Based Off Performance or Set Price
        - Discuss The Relationship With Client 7 - 10 days before Month End
        - If Client Dissatisfied, Find the Root cause /(Contractor)
        - If Client Satisfied, Find New Client
        - Expand
        - Marketing and Promotion
    - Content Creation (eg. Review Website)
        - Study Content Creation
        - Audience
        - Maintenance
    - Affiliate Marketing Website
        - Ad Creation
        - Brand Chain
    - Dropshipping Website
        - Branding
        - Study Customer Service
        - Find a Good/Great Dropshipper
        - Try Out Different Products
    - E-commerce Website
        - Brand Security
        - Products
        - Secure Spreadsheet
        - Secure Database
7. Functionality to consider

    - Business Automation
    - Take Advantage Of AI
8. Becoming Successful Is Painful, But It's Worth It

About Author

Book enthusiast and reviewer on Finance, Personal Development and Business pieces, Reitumetse Bokang Allen Sethabela is a young entrepreneur from South Africa. Fostering a personal brand of **Allen Reiley** and a digital product based business, he runs an email newsletter and website that discusses starting and launching start-up businesses. He has a mission to aid others in taking steps toward self betterment and an improved financial life, by reflecting the knowledge and wisdom gained from his experiences and books he’s read to others.

Introduction

To start and to own a business is something many people dream of, but very few people act on this dream due many different reasons, one of them being that they may lack the resources and inventory to start the business. Fortunately, starting a business in this day and age is the easiest it's ever been; sure, there'll be many hurdles and competition to overcome, but getting started shouldn't be an impossible barrier. This book will provide a basic layout of things to do and take into consideration, it provides a guide on how to get started with minimal to no start up capital, but understand that this is not a "Get Rich Fast" book, it may take time and a lot of effort to finally become profitable, but it will be worth it. If you need money urgently, then this book may not have what you're looking for. As long as you have internet and a basic understanding of the web (such as how to navigate a website), then you'll be able to gather the necessary resources to start your business, even if you have no particularly unique skills.

This book is to inform you on important things to consider when starting a business, with a layout of how some of the discussed business models are run at the end. This book is designed to help you land your 1st customer with resources to help maintain a solid business structure.

To know how to scale your business, network, land partnerships and everything else, you'll have to be part of our community. Though before that can be a concern, focus your time and resources into landing your 1st few clients/customers.

Getting Started

To get started, you must design a start up plan, and this plan must contain steps and processes of how you intend on building a stable foundation for your business and procedures to follow in order to make sure you're able to maintain and grow the business. Of course, reading business, finance, marketing and social psychology books will be of great benefit due to all businesses being reliant on their ability to get customers. So understanding the client and how the market works before starting your business can help steer you into the right direction. In your business plan, make sure to consider the concepts discussed in the following chapters. The chapters that follow will provide you with a concrete framework of the psychology behind buyer intent and what to consider when creating a system for your business.

Business Model

Start by identifying a list of at least 5 different business models you'd like to adopt. By knowing the different kinds of business models you'll base your business off of, you'll be able to do research on the pros and cons of each business model, allowing you to identify the risks, advantages and challenges you'll face. From this list, you'll be able to narrow things down to the risks you're willing to manage, the obstacles your skill set will allow you to overcome and the advantages you're looking to exploit. Examples of business models are:

1. Dropshipping
2. Amazon FBA
3. Affiliate Marketing
4. Advertising/Marketing Agency
5. Content Creation
6. Newsletter
7. Personal Brand
8. Freelance

The list is vast, with there being over 30 different business models that you can take advantage of. It does help to study the parameters on how your selected business operates, make sure to understand all the laws and procedures that are involved too.

If you take Marketing for example, make sure to be well versed in the underlying concepts of marketing (selling, closing and copyright included); studying these won't take long, a month should be enough depending on the individual. This is so that you can address any issue that may arise with familiarity and understanding, which allows you to communicate problems with clients and find solutions, showing professionalism and this also works to build trust as you'll be perceived as being competent and reliable.

The pro tip is to find a business model that provides a high value skill that isn't too difficult to study, allowing you to build a business that's steered toward a potential high income stream when up and running.

Niche

A niche is essentially the business category or industry you'd like to get behind. Finding a niche is important because it allows you to narrow down on a select few who may have an interest in your product or service, which is better than trying to create an item made for everyone; realistically speaking, people have different tastes, wants and needs, so it's impossible to sell a product to the entire market.

Having a niche will allow you to identify a particular industry that you find interesting, and this allows you to specialize in the selected niche. The better you become within the said niche, the more your products and services will be valued, attracting more customers as a result. The reliability and trust associated with your brand is most often what brings clients to your doorstep, because they are certain you will fulfill their needs and wants. The best businesses in the world all choose 1 niche and master it, so it's best to do the same, & you'll develop better insight, which will allow you to see opportunities and ways on how to manage risk.

Examples of a business niche are:

1. Productivity
2. Health and fitness
3. Technology
4. Cooking
5. Finance

These are just a few out of a really long list, it's also possible to be more specific, to which you'd select niches such as:

1. Perfumes
2. Watches
3. Health based supplements
4. A foreign language class
5. Website development

Whichever you choose should be strongly linked to your interests, allowing you to focus as you go in depth with your research and discovery. It's hard to start a business, so selecting a niche that bores you or one that doesn't motivate you will only result in disaster. It's worth mentioning that each niche has different profit margins, so be careful to not select a niche that has a low profit margin because it will stifle the growth of your business.

Other things to take into account will be your ability to make the most of what you have. An example being the difference between selecting a general niche and a particularly specific niche. A general niche like E-commerce allows you to handle a wide variety of products and services, allowing you to get the most out of having more customers roll in because of the available product range, with the downside being that you'll most likely be required to stay up to date with the latest trends of different products and services alike. A particularly specific niche (eg. watches) allows you to specifically identify the watch market, and this has you take advantage of your markets interests, granting you the ability to easily keep track of all seasonal changes and provide good quality watches, possibly outperforming the competition; the downside is that your audience may not be as large as that of a general niche, but at least you'll be able to draw more value out of each transaction than you would with general niches. Both approaches are effective and important, with each having its upsides and downsides, so by also really understanding your niche, you'll be able to produce much better results.

Service/Product

Create a product or service.

A service or product is the heart of every start up business, because a good service or product will allow a business's brand and reputation to grow much faster with fewer

obstacles. Of course, your provided service or product should be in line with your selected niche and business model, and make sure your service or product are able to fulfill their purpose well; in other words, do not provide a service or product that does not provide a good solution to a problem. Finance shouldn't be an issue, in fact it isn't, creating a good product or service as a new business will be difficult and will take a lot of effort, but it is doable, and the internet has a vast vault of free tools and resources that can be used to build your product or service. Seeing we're dealing with online services and products, getting started is honestly not too difficult; providing a data entry service is one example that would take a day at most to learn and master.

Services that are online may often require a certain level of skill and experience, and because we're aiming for high income skills and services, which we're probably not well versed in enough to provide. Though it may seem like a dead end, it truly isn't, because after the client pays upfront, you'll be able to hire a freelancer from Upwork, LinkedIn or Fiverr to do the job, allowing you to exploit the services of a well established and well trusted service provider. Hiring someone soon after getting an order is a good approach, but at times it can be risky, because the freelancer may have a que of clients to attend to before dealing with your case, or that it could take a while for someone to respond, and this delay in service may tarnishe your branding. Fortunately, I have a less drastic yet similar strategy, where you and your business act as a machine that connects clients with service providers, allowing you to capitalize off of the transactions made, which will be covered later on in this book.

The point is, try to do research on services and products that are in high demand, don't be intimidated by competition and the lack of start-up capital because those things can be dealt with, rather focus on what's going to help you generate a good income stream. By identifying the service or product that you have an interest in, you'll be able to structure how you'd like the service or product to be constructed (eg. A one time purchase or subscription based purchase). Understand the market surrounding the service or products, know where and when the service is more needed or most valuable. The thing that sells most is a solution to a pain point, not something that looks glamorous, this puts a sense of urgency that will increase the likelihood that your service or product is bought.

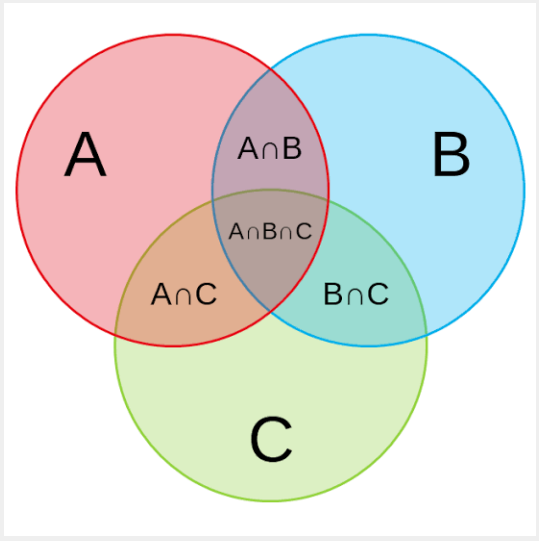
Subscription based services or products are the overall structure I recommend, because this provides you with a stable income stream where you'll be able to know your monthly earnings upfront. Services or products that are one time offers usually require the business to focus most of its resources to getting as many sales as possible, and though it's possible, it's extremely tiring and adds the likelihood of there being months where sales are low and income isn't that much.

Dealing with both products and services is a good strategy because you'll be able to capitalize on both subscription based services and a product sale if you choose to take this route. A good product can serve as a passive source of income for the upcoming future. The best approach is to provide a service that solves a recurring issue, one that needs constant attention, you'll make good money off of that because when a client provides monthly payment, your efforts will be channeled into improving the quality of your service, allowing your business to grow and develop much faster while establishing a good brand name. A membership is a great way to start a subscription based business model, you can teach your members about the best practices to lose weight, or the best practices to design websites and etc, pick a problem that takes time to turn your customer from being a newbie to being a pro, and with the right pricing model, 20 to 500 members will be all you need for a $10K business a month.

When creating a product or service, ask yourself these 3 questions:

1. What do I like doing?
2. What am I good at?
3. What problems can I solve?

With this cliche yet important principle at mind, you'll be able to flush out all your thoughts and emotions, because truth be told the sheer number of products you can create in the beginning is overwhelming and you may not know what to do.



Ven Diagram

Draw 3 overlapping circles to lable them A to C. Each circle will act as a bubble that contains the answers you got from asking yourself the top questions. You can do so by assigning a question to a letter, eg:

1. A - What you like
2. B - What you're good at
3. C - The problems you can solve

In practice, it would be something similar to this:

A. What do I like?
    - I like writing
    - I like reading
    - I like having free time
B. What am I good at?
    - I'm good at organizing
    - I'm good at cooking
    - I'm good at setting priorities
C. What problems can I solve?
    - I can create systems that help organize people's work so that they have more free time
    - I can create quick lunch box recipes and meals for lazy or busy people
    - I can create study schedules for college exams

Insert your answers into the circles and see where they overlap, the thing you find to be at the center of the 3 overlapping circles will be what you can turn into a product or service. You'll be able to do it because you're good at it, you'll be able to improve on your skills because you like it and you'll be able to scale because you know what problem you'll be solving.

Remember, your product doesn't have to be perfect, just get a demo and have people test it out and give you feedback for you to improve on the product as time goes, and for you to know if it's worth investing a lot of time in or not.

This book for example took more than a year to be complete, with numerous versions and updates. Your product will grow with your business, don't be afraid to experiment.

Target Audience

Your target audience are the people who your niche is focused on. A niche alone isn't enough to act as an indicator for a target audience (if your chosen niche is Productivity or Health and fitness, who exactly are your target audience?). A target audience within a niche should be selected for the best optimal performance of the business, an active exercise manual may be well desired in the health and fitness community but may not be a good choice for the elderly.



This means if you choose to sell watches for example, you should know which watches are meant for which age group; you should know your brand style, meaning the overall ecstatic surrounding your business should be understood by you so you know which groups of people you attract (eg. Selling professional, flashy & techy watches.). With a professional collection, you know that you'll be attracting investors, businessmen and anyone who looks to possess a professional appeal for certain occasions. There is more to selecting your target audience, identification factors such as age, gender, profession, customer interest and many other things should be taken into account when choosing an audience.

One variable that I consider to be most important that most people overlook is the financial level of the target audience. When a person starts a new business, they most often think of a cheap service or product to offer so that people buy, and though it does work, it's not a good way to become successful before you burn out. If you intend on providing a service or product that's in demand, then target an audience that's willing to pay a good amount of money for that particular service. In short, a good audience to target is one that desperately needs your services or product.

A great way to choose your target audience is to have an avatar, and this avatar should be constructed as a real person. Think about the things you like and identify the things you spend a lot of money on, an example for females is that they buy a lot of make-up and nails. Now, you'll have the beauty industry be your area of focus, because a lot of the time you may actually know a thing or 2 about the things you like buying, and because you buy it you'll also realize that other people also buy it, allowing you to have a concrete idea on the reasons why others may buy the same product and what made it so appealing. Another thing to look into are the habits of your customer avatar, and they can reflect your own behavior perhaps… let's say you like going on Pinterest to search terms like “Money manifestation” and “Attracting Money”, when you go onto Pinterest Trends, you'll go take a look to see if other people are searching for these terms or not because now you've identified Pinterest as a source of traffic. If the term you looked for has a high search volume, identify the gender stats to know which demographic to focus on, and in this instance the term “Money manifestation” is popular among women with thousands of monthly searches. So now, you have a term that you know will attract people of similar interest. You can then start making pins about money manifestation and link them to your blog giving more advice to manifest money, then at the end you can talk about an ebook, course or membership you have to teach women how to start their own make-up business, or tell them about the line of products you have.

That was a rough overview as an example, a customer avatar is essentially the central focus of your business, you know their web history, their interests, their pains, their purchasing history, their city and much more, it should be someone who's psychology you can understand so that everything you say from your messaging to your sales pitch will resonate with them on a deep level. Once you know your customer avatar, everyone around the focus of interest will be your target audience.

Website (Landing page, Blog, Commercial site & etc.)

Once your brand, services and products are set, create a webpage or website where your services will be advertised. Creating a website these days is absolutely easy and affordable, using well established website builders like Strikingly, WordPress, Wix and Squarespace, you can create websites for free or for a fee depending on your needs and chosen platform.

A website is important for your business because it's where all the potential customers will find out about your services and is also where they'll be able to place their orders, make a purchase or find your details for contact. A well structured website will allow you to draw in a readers attention, and generate a lead. The best way to generate leads specifically tailored for your niche, it to have a function that asks visitors for their email address, that way they'll be kept up to date with each product or service you post about, and you can use their contacts to give them promotions which may draw in their attention for a purchase.

For business models that require a large number of visitors, a website is a great asset because once you gain ten thousand visitors (or less) a month to your website, you'll get paid through ad revenue by having ads run on your website, making for passive income as you wait for clients to make their purchase.

Make sure that the website builder you choose provides the proper functionality that meets your needs and desires. For example, products can't be sold on a business landing page or an art gallery page.

Be aware of the difference between a landing page, a blog and a commercial site, because all three serve a different function, yet all are important. A blog is typically there to make reviews, give news updates and generally have the owner of the blog write about anything they believe will be of relevance to their audience. A blog is essentially a tool used to build topical authority, letting Google know that you're an expert on a given topic with each published article you make, allowing your page to rank higher on Google while also getting you an increasing volume of traffic over time.

A landing page is a simple form or page that requests visitors to take a single action, perhaps it's to book an audit, to buy a product or sign a form, a landing page is most

often used in what's referred to as a funnel to get customers enrolled in a customer journey before having them make a purchase.

A commercial site is basically a website filled with different product listings and is usually an online store with a shopping cart. These sites are great for giving visitors to a website a large variety of products to choose from, allowing them to select what they want, which may land a couple of sales without you having to be involved in the process.

In all instances, these websites must be optimized to rank on Google. So you may want to invest in learning about SEO or getting someone to do it for you, and what SEO stands for is “Search Engine Optimization”, which just means including the words your customers search for in the messaging of your website. Good SEO can bring consistent passive traffic to your business, and improving on it from time to time can even 2x or 10x your websites reach, making you more money.

Pricing

Pricing is probably the thing entrepreneurs have the most difficulty setting up because they have to balance the product or service value and profitability in a way that will allow the business to sustain its margins.

Pricing determines who buys and who doesn't buy, what sells and what doesn't. Businesses end up reducing their prices to attract more customers, and this results in many businesses dying off because they aren't making enough money. The thing to understand here is that people like to buy, but hate to be sold; also understand that there's no such thing as "They won't be able to afford it.", people aren't eager to buy the cheapest thing, they are after value, people will buy a good bargain. Here's a good illustrations; if I were to park outside your house with the latest Lamborghini and say to you that I'm willing to give you this car for $10 000 and I'll give you a week to buy it (use your countries currency in substitute of the dollar sign)... after I say that, chances are you're going to make sure you make 10 grand by the end of the week because you know that a Lamborghini is worth far more than the amount I bargained for. Though of course, as a business starter, you don't have a Lamborghini to make an offer with, but the principle of value can still be taken advantage of.

A more practical example is if you were to sell burgers for instance. The small burger costs $5, the medium costs $6 and the large costs $9, by this line up, people are most likely to buy the $6 burger because it's a bargain, a person will receive a larger burger just by adding an extra dollar. If you were to change the pricing to $5 for the small

burger, $8 for the medium and $9 for the large, now the burger that will be sold more is the large.

In a service or product business where more than 1 unit is sold, where the middle service or product lies in price will determine which product sells the most on average. When creating prices for your products or services, determine the rarity and base value of that service or skill, then create a custom price system based on that information and use the middle service or product to act as a persuasive tool that draws in sales for the desired service or product.

Methods of Payment

When it comes to payment methods, it becomes tricky when it comes to transactions between banks. Using a global platform like PayPal for example allows for quick and easy transactions. It's important to establish proper payment methods to ensure smooth sailing, and in the case where you have a monthly retainer, set up an automatic invoice system that notifies and bills the client automatically to avoid any awkward confrontation when payments have to be made.

Use at least 3 different kinds of platforms in case the client doesn't have access to the platform you prefer due to restriction laws that differ from country to country. Also know and understand the pros and cons of each platform you use so that you're prepared for any unexpected misbehaving from the used platform.

Some of the most popular ones are:

1. Stripe
2. PayPal
3. Wise
4. Pioneer

Each charge different rates, have different transaction times and are available in different countries. Having 3 to 5 payment processors can be a life saver, as you can avoid alienating a potentially large segment of your customers.

MVP

MVP stands for "Minimal Viable Product", and the role of an MVP is to provide free value, a free service or product to the clients.

When you're a new business, it's not always a good idea to charge people right off the bad. Your target market doesn't know who you are, there's no level of trust established and the market doesn't know whether you are legitimate or not. Clients won't buy a product or service that they aren't sure will be of value or of great benefit. The purpose of a MVP is to establish the brands accreditability and allows to build trust & value into the brand name. The level of value presented in a MVP will either have clients want to try out your products or services, or will have them give your brand a bad review from the start, so though a MVP is free, it should be one of (if not) your best work, you should provide actual value that clients will be comfortable investing capital in.

In other words, a MVP is to build leads, and what leads are can basically be described as points of interest, leads are potential clients in this case. The more leads you have, the more potential clients you have. If you have a subscription based service, place it within your MVP, and if you can get people to subscribe based then your service will succeed, likewise, if no one subscribes, then it means your product or service needs some work.

MVPs are time expensive yet financially cheap ways to see if your business idea will succeed or not based on the products performance, allowing you to address any issues before your business launches, allowing you to maximize efficiency and profit while getting an actual engagement with your market to know what works and what doesn't work.

Make sure to collect their email and name whenever they download the MVP, so that you can save them as a potential client that you can warm up in an email marketing campaign to retarget them for the sale. Chances are, if your free guide genuinely helped them with something, they will be more inclined to buy your product or service because of the value they received in your free content.

Client Contract

In the case that you provide a service that requires a service from business to business whether large scale or small, a contract is needed to record the agreement on paper in digital format. Creating a client contract is far from the easiest thing to do, but it is necessary to ensure that the agreements are respected and maintained, it allows for trust and assurance to be set.

I have a free contract for Social Media Marketing Agencies that deal in Digital Marketing displayed in the link at the end of this section. This contract was designed by professional copyrighters and was published by a reliable source, anyone who's looking to start a SMMA is free to download and edit it to meet their needs.

In the case that you run a different business model, you'll be required to find sources to make this contract for you or you make it yourself. Hiring someone to create this contract is affordable on Fiverr and Upwork.

Click here: SMMA Contract

Independent Trader Contract

An independent trader is basically a freelancer who accepts working for your brand or business and only gets paid after delivering the service. To hire an Independent trader is a process known as *Contractor Arbitrage*, and all this means is that you can have an expert in a certain field work under you as a contractor, which means they'll provide all the services within your niche at a fee.

The way this works is that after finding a contractor, they'll remain on standby until you find a client. Once you find a client, the client pays for the service (usually at the start of the month), and you'll pay the contractor once they've delivered the service (usually at the end of the month). A contract isn't necessarily needed, it's also just a way of serving as an agreement among the 2 parties saved in digital format.

You and the independent trader are free to discuss the agreements on a zoom call, I'll put the link to the contract in case you want a secure agreement.

It's worth taking note that you will have to modify the contract to your preference and you're free to remove anything that may not be of use to you. You'll have to identify certain acts and law procedures, which you'll have to modify according to the laws of your state or country.

Click here: Independent Trader Contract

Finding an Independent Trader (Contractor)

Finding an Independent Trader is simpler than it sounds actually. An Independent Trader is basically a freelancer, so creating a job posting on Upwork saying you're looking for an independent trader who has ("particular skill set") and ("particular experience") within ("your businesses selected niche"), you will get a good number of replies within a day or 2. Also specify that you'll host interviews on a Zoom call and you may interview all of them in the same call at ("selected date & time"), also send a world clock link if you can.

Before the call begins, make sure you're well prepared and that you know a lot about your selected niche (eg. Digital Marketing) so that you can ask questions that matter. You'll be able to identify the people who actually know their stuff and discuss different strategies to get a gauge of their way of thinking. Ask them to send you their records, history and experience to you via email 2 or 3 days prior to the zoom call so you can check out if they are legitimate or not, allowing you to select who to put on call ahead of time.

Once the call is over, you should keep in touch with your contractor as you will be required to keep them on standby. You can use this as a great opportunity to discuss how you'll work together in management of the business while you are still searching for clients.

The beautiful thing about this is that their references become yours, meaning you can use their history as your business history, allowing your business to have credibility and a good record by the time you launch.

It's worth taking note that this will work well if you're able to pay your contractor a good sum of money that they'll be happy with. Getting a high skill contractor allows you to get high paying clients who are in need of the services your business provides. The contractor doesn't have to know how much you charge clients as well, allowing you to have full control of your profit margins.

Copywriting

Copywriting is probably the most powerful skill anyone can adopt, period. *Dan Lok* describes copywriting as "*The ability to use written text to persuade someone to take an action.*". Copy refers to text or content created, and copy is everywhere; on Facebook posts, Tweets, YouTube, websites and etc. If you've ever asked people to make a comment about something on your Facebook post or asked for reactions, that's copywrite.

Copywriting is an easy to learn and a high demand skill, and all copywriting demands you to do is to write text in a persuasive way to have readers want to take action. A good copywriter can change the text on a website and this would result in a 2x to 3x increase in profits and sales, hence why companies and businesses are always looking for copywriters.

When you've learned the skill of copywriting, you'll be able to use this skill to persuade clients into clicking on your product or service link to make a purchase, basically granting you the ability to generate cash flow on demand. Good copy will allow you to generate leads and make sales with reduced difficulty.

It is possible to write amazing copy even without studying copywriting, though the knowledge behind what makes a good copy can help improve the overall performance of the copy you like. Fortunately, copywriting is not too complex and everyone can learn all the basics in a month. Below is a breakdown of copywriting writing frameworks you can start implementing today.

AIDA

AIDA is a popular copywriting framework which is an acronym for Attention, Interest, Desire and Action. The framework essentially captures the attention of the reader and guides them along a decision making process.

Attention
Grabbing attention usually begins with a bold statement, usually a promise, at the top of the copy to get someone to stop what they're doing and make them want to read more. Attention can be grabbed by calling out your target market, examples being:

“*Attention Freelancer…”*
Or
“*E-commerce businesses are doubling their revenue with these strategies”*

This does mean that when in the process of writing your copy you'll have to know what catches the attention or your market and find ways to communicate their desires back to them, or simply call them out in order to get the desired response from them.

Interest
Interest can be created in different ways, it depends on the level of arousal you want the reader to have. A short report of who got the benefits from the attention grabbing statement you made is an effective way to build intrigue as the reader immediately realizes that there may be value for them to extract from your copy, example being:

“*12 November, Jack's business was suffering and was about to die.*

Traffic was running low and his finances were a mess

Rent was due tomorrow

He had missed 4 payments already and was on his final warning

Like a dried up leaf, he sulked while shriveled up in the warmth of his dark room

Then a notification struck…

His eyes, wet and wrinkled, suddenly lit up with joy in an instant as he read…

‘500 downloads made
$30 000 deposited into bank account’”

You're more than welcome to be creative with your writing, write your copy in a manner that begs the question “*How?*”. If you succeed with intriguing the reader, you've succeeded in making them want to stay to read the rest of your copy.

Desire
Building desire is crucial as it makes your reader want to have the solution your product or service offers. Desire can be built through describing what benefits others are indulging in from using your product or service, let's continue the given example with:

“*The doors of a red Ferrari close*

Pulling out his phone, a graph displaying exponential growth is shown

Only 6 months have passed

Yet…

Jack is living lavishly

As if he was never a broke college student selling downloadable Notion templates

His business has scaled to six figures with him using the same method that got him the 500 downloads that changed his life

The method that I want to share with you today”

Remember to write your copy in an inviting and conversational manner, and it's not a must to write things in dialogue format. Making it sound as if you're doing things out of kindness plays to the reader's psychology, making them want your product or service.

Action
Once you're done with building desire, it's good practice to tell the reader what they should do in order to fulfill their desire. This means you should direct them to a strong CTA (Call To Action). Example being:

“*You can just like Jack!*

One call changed his life, and it will surely change yours

Click the link below to book a free evaluation

An seasoned e-commerce expert will give you a free 5 minute audit on what can work help boost your sales”

Then on the call you can arrange a paid coaching session with the reader and just trust that the person on the phone is a solid sales person.

PAS

PAS stands for Problem, Agitate, Solve. With this framework, you identify a problem that your target Avatar is facing, then agitate the pain points, to which you'll provide your product or service as the solution.

Problem
The problem you raise can either be superficial or be a legitimate case, and either way it has to be a problem that your target avatar is facing. This is really powerful when done right, because a lot of the time people are aware of a problem and haven't been touching up on it to finally fix it, or that they're completely unaware that there is a problem and that it needs to be solved. In some instances, you have to be sensitive with your language to not offend anyone, especially when physical appearances are involved. Examples are:

"*Black Smoke? Your car is killing itself!*"
Or
"Look away! That studio equipment is outdated!"

You can go for wording that's less dramatic, though the thing I hope you're catching on to is that though the problem was addressed, it's not in a manner that attacks or offends the reader.

Agitate
You can agitate a problem by either making remarks about it, describing how it's holding the individual down or how they would be much better without the problem. Referring to the studio equipment for example, you can write:

"Why settle for audio that's sub-par? It's damaging your production"
Or
"Ancient relics belong in the past, it'll turn your studio into something of the past and your clients will gravitate towards fresher sounds"

Structure the pain points in ways that aim to agitate the reasons why the "problem" is a threat, to the reason why the solution is important. To better explain this, a person would open a studio because they want to start a business… by having the studio owner know that their old equipment will ruin their business is a pain point heavy enough for them to take action.

Solution
Assuming you addressed the problem and agitated it, the reader will want an immediate solution, of which you'll present your product or service as the perfect solution… & because you would have articulated their problems better than they can, they'll see you as the expert and will trust your product or service more, increasing the likelihood of them buying. Examples of this would be:

"Here are quality microphones that won't break the bank"
Or
"Worried about cash? Don't worry about it. Here are affordable tools to turn your studio into a money making machine"

Simplicity is key, don't try to hide your intentions behind clever wording. Be direct and concise, perhaps a little persuasive even, because the reader will still have to pull out their bank card to

make a purchase, and as such you should be transparent or else they'll see through it and will not buy. Make the solution sound perfect, while addressing any counter arguments the reader may make.

FAB

FAB is highly effective for products or software, it stands for Features, Advantages, Benefits. This framework identifies the product features, what advantages it gives the user and what benefits the user gets from the product.

Features
Features are essentially what make a product unique. In terms of cellphones, the features written on the box are usually misunderstood and are too confusing for most people, though are still written there because buyers understand that these features have their significance and may at least have an idea on what benefits 1 or 2 of these features may serve them. Example:

“
16” HD Screen
1TB Rom
16GB RAM
“

The features discuss what the product has in terms of internal components, which helps distinguish it from the market at large. When writing features, a bullet format is often recommended.

Advantages
When talking about advantages, try addressing things that are exclusive to the product or things that the product does better than its competitors. You wouldn't want to say things like “*make long distance calls*”, that's something every phone can do, statements like that are what make copy lose its depth and impact. Examples:

“Never worry about your phone slipping from your hands, with a 16in screen, it'll fit nice and snug in your hands.”
Or
“Never need to buy an external memory device again, this phone's storage has you covered for life!”

An advantage usually works to overcome a common issue or problem, making the purchase convenient because the customer won't need to worry about the drawbacks and hassles associated with a product.

Benefit
Benefits and advantages may be seen as being the same thing to many people, though try to make a distinction if possible. Use advantages to overcome issues while using benefits to enhance the product's appeal. Examples:

“Watch movies in comfort with the cinematic screen”
Or
“Fit a million memories in your pocket”

I'm not well versed in cell phone copy, though hopefully you get the gist.

A better way to describe FAB, eg. Shoes:

Feature: Shock absorbent foam
Advantage: Allows athletes to run without absorbing the impact of each step
Benefit: Makes athlete 2x faster

4P’s

The 4 P's stand for Promise, Picture, Proof, Push. Essentially, it means making a big promise, painting a vivid picture of it, giving proof then pushing for a CTA. This framework is concise and persuasive, and it's usually used for high ticket offers.

Promise
The big promise, that's what you have to craft, and usually if people skip it, it's not big enough. Your promise has to be a blend of an unbelievable offer and achievable results. Example:

“Lose 100 lb in 2 weeks!”
Or
“Get 2 inches taller in 3 weeks”

The promise has to address a dream state or outcome your target market desperately desires but lacks the knowledge or dedication to achieve it. The sky's the limit, though make sure to not lie or mislead people, or else it'll damage your brand.

Picture
Paint a vivid picture in the reader's mind, make it so clear that they're immersed in it, and that they see themselves in the picture if possible. Using simple language is the best way to deliver your message, and as we unmask the subject, we find that you're free to paint a picture that highlights a problem or something else. Example:

“*Sitting on the couch, eating pizza*

A bottle of coke on the side

Clock strikes 9pm, it's bedtime

Though… moving isn't what it used to be…

Knees hurt, chest feels heavy with each attempt made to stand

Self pity floods the mind, feet cracking in pain and with each step made

Sounds like you?

Don't worry, we can help"

When painting a picture, try to capture as much of the moment as possible without being long winded and boring, at the same time avoid writing text that's too short or lacking creativity.

Proof
Proof is easy to fill assuming you have a few past clients/customers. If you have no past clients whatsoever, avoid using the 4 P's framework, at least until you get around 5. Giving proof doesn't require much copywriting skill, though it does help to ask to use the customers name and image when they give a review, just to make the testimonials feel genuine. When presenting testimonials and success stories, use words such as:

"*What others have to say*"
Or
"*What our customers think*"

Generally, the more people you have as living testimonials, the better.

Push
"Push" is as it sounds. Using your copy, you'll nudge and push the reader into taking the action you require them to take. You can go for a soft or hard CTA, though either way the reader will be able to tell that you're trying to sell them something with this framework, so be clever with how you write your copy and CTA.

Generating Leads

There's a Golden Law in business that states "*Everything is downstream of lead generation*", what this means is that no matter how good your business model is, your business will not succeed unless you're able to generate leads. Lead Generation is the bread and butter of every business, so without the ability to generate leads, your business will not thrive.

Fortunately, lead generation is a skill that can be learned and improved on as time progresses.
Places where you can find leads are:

1. Facebook Groups
2. Instagram
3. Telegram
4. Google maps
5. Google
6. Pinterest

These are free platforms to use where you'll be able to find leads. There you can make posts to generate interest, chat with people to build a network and on Instagram you can search up your niche & on the followers list of your found results you can find profiles and the emails of your potential clients. More efficient methods are paid services such as *Leads Gorilla* and etc.

Through the means of email marketing for example, you'll be able to send people your free MVP if you have one, and this will draw leads toward your brand, allowing you to narrow in on potential clients. Once you get a subscription or order, you'll be able to contact your contractor to start with the 1st project the client needs.

There are less commonly known websites that get a high traffic volume that aren't being taken advantage of. I for one use TrafficAdBar to send a thousand new visitors to my website everyday and the service is free.

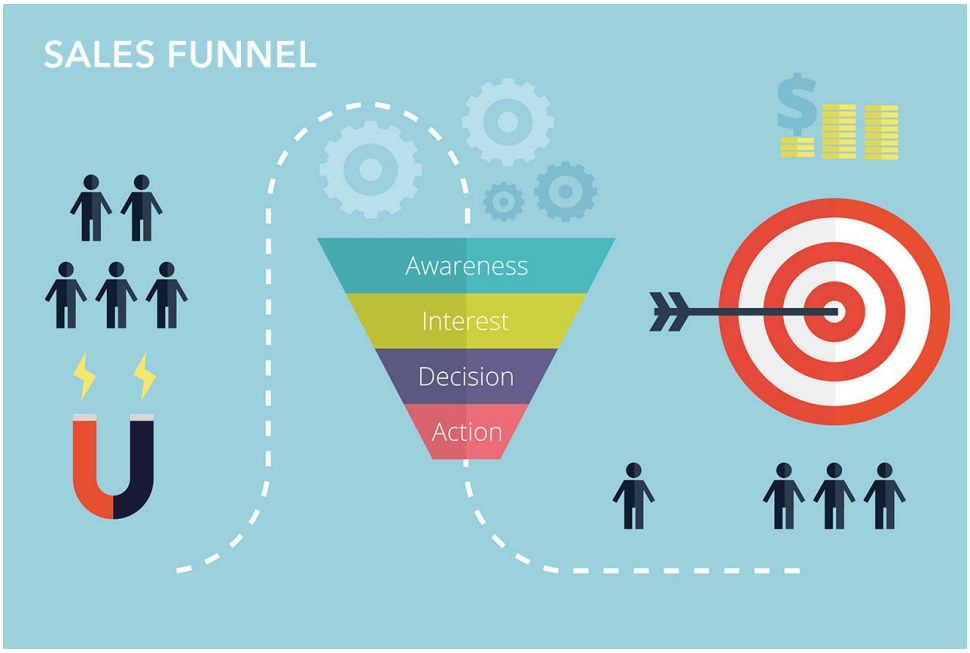
Some of the less commonly known sites are:

1. PennySaverUsa.com
2. HercuList.com
3. WorldProfit.com
4. Rumble
5. SlideShare
6. Answers
7. MeWe

All these platforms are unsaturated and it's fairly easy to build a following and a strong brand from these platforms because competition is low. Some allow you to make free web ads, email ads and downloadable PDFs to build your brand awareness and following.

Funnel

A funnel is a term used to describe the journey the customer experiences in order to know, trust and ultimately buy from you or your business. Funnels are usually represented in a visual diagram to simplify the process because they can become very complex based on the business and the market share it's trying to target. Now, funnels are essential, regardless of the niche you're in or the business model you pursue, you'll have to familiarize yourself with funnels because a well executed funnel can 10x your business, promising immeasurable returns.



A sales funnel is the process used to convert your audience *(leads)* into potential customers.

- **Awareness**: Awareness is the top of the funnel and is the beginning of your marketing campaign. This level of the funnel is where you use your product or offer *(or MVP)* as bait to grab the attention of readers, this *"bait"* is referred to as a **Lead Magnet.**
- **Interest**: Interest is the part of the funnel where readers gain interest in your product or service, the number of people who get interested will be lower than the number of people who saw the lead magnet, and is why the funnel gets narrow.
- **Decision**: This is the point in the funnel where customers check your product or service, start comparing its price and value to other products and services as they evaluate whether they need/want it or not.
- **Action**: This is the part of the funnel where readers become clients and purchase your product or service. The number of people at the bottom of the funnel are usually far less than the people who are aware of your product or service.

Funnels are a great asset to have because they allow you to spread out your marketing into manageable sections, they allow you to know which segment performed well and which performed badly, allowing you to adjust the *Copy* of that particular segment, essentially allowing you to optimize and modify your marketing in an easy to manage process.

A funnel exists to make leads get familiar with your brand, to build trust and have them make micro commitments that train them to buy your product in the future, these micro commitments can be referred to as *CTA's* (Call To Action). I'm sure you've seen influencers ask you to tap the follow/subscribe button and like their post, or those posts that say "click the link below" and/or websites with buttons that say "buy now" and "add to cart". All of these small requests are CTA's, and all a CTA does is ask the viewer to take an action of your choosing.

When a funnel is broken down, the CTAs and customer journey will vary in length and level of commitment based on how expensive the product or service is. A funnel made for accounting services will be longer, filled with more proof of authority and testimonials, emails and video sales calls, while a funnel to sell clothing online will be shorter, consisting of an email subscription and occasional emails leading to the product website. This is important to know, because even if you were to construct amazing emails, you must know exactly how much time it would take to convert customers, allowing you to optimize for the appropriate funnel length.

Funnels are usually initiated with an ad, spread out to as many people as possible to attract clicks, to which the funnel handles the rest of the customer journey. It is possible to generate clicks organically, though you'll have to own a decent following and an engaged audience.

Now, regardless of how well your funnel is, it all falls flat if the landing page or webpage the traffic is sent to doesn't convert. Though it is important for you to study funnels, here's a breakdown on how to convert warm and cold traffic to your website:

1. **Headline**: When visitors land on your page, 80% of the traffic's attention will be drawn to the headline. The headline has to make a ***bold claim***, you have to the WIIFM (What's In It For Me) and have readers know what the big benefit of staying on your page is. Social media is competitive with millions of highly entertaining content out there, and your headline must address the benefit of being on your site to the reader in a way that catches their interest, or else they'll leave. Examples are:
    a. Never Run Out Of Sales Again!
    b. Lose Weight In 10 Days
    c. Make 10K In 2 Weeks With This New Side Hustle
    d. 10x Your Productivity With These Proven Methods
2. **Subheadline**: The subheadline is what retains attention, which often handles objections and clarifies how the promised outcome can be achieved. Always assume that your traffic is filled with highly intelligent individuals, as such, use that as an opportunity to find believable and achievable outcomes to enhance the claim while building credibility. Examples are:
    a. With A Funnel That Has Made Us Millions In Sales
    b. With Our High Intensity Workout Plan That Has Helped Hundreds Of People Lose Weight Fast!
    c. Join the millions of people who have made fortunes with this method
    d. A step by step guide on how we achieved superhuman productivity

The headline and Subheadliine are the 1st thing visitors see, and this top area of a website/landing page is often referred to as the *Hero Section*. Within the Hero Section, to to establish Authority and Credibility, either with:

1. A star based review right under your CTA to have others know that your service or product is recommendable
2. A featured section to show the media platforms you've been featured on

This blend of an attention grabbing headline, a convincing subheading, a straight forward CTA and a strong establishment of trust is a sure fire way to convert many visitors to your page without them needing to scroll down to reach more of your page.

When your website is set up to concert, create a separate page that has a ton load of value to offer, especially if you're a service based business. In this separate page, provide a short video or text course/master class that's around 10 to 30 minutes long, of you teaching people how to solve a given problem and ways they can better themselves from the value you've offered. This will instantly build trust between you and the cold traffic you've accumulated, and it'll allow visitors to see 1st hand how your services may help them and impact their life/career. At the end of the video, add a CTA which leads to your product or service. Those who stayed till the end are far more likely to make a purchase because they've shown enough interest in your content to want to consume more of it. Most product based funnels won't need this, though it's worth mentioning that it's highly effective for products that are worth more than $100.

A sales funnel that usually converts above 10% of the traffic it receives finds ways to entertain, educate and foster trust with visitors, which really ends up having the warm leads hold a personal relationship with the brand or person behind the brand. A breakdown of a funnel you can try is:

1. **Awareness and CTA**: Through a post, video, podcast, blog or ad, provide a certain level of informative and helpful tips to catch people's attention, then ask them to click through your link.
2. **Retention**: Send your traffic to a page that has a video or text post that provides a wall of valuable information that the traffic can put to use, and at the end of it ask them to sign up to your free newsletter.
3. **Trust**: Over a period that you deem fit, send personalized emails to nurture your leads, provide value and have them tap on links that lead to your blog or content where they'll be able to get more free content, to which you'd give subtle reminders that you have a product or service that can help them a lot.
4. **Affirm their beliefs**: Within your emails, optimally once in every 5 emails, give success stories on how your product or service has helped you or someone else reach a desired outcome, the challenges faced and how easy the product or service made it for the outcome to be attained.

By repeating this process, you'll be able to capture and retain the attention of your subscribers while building further trust as you'll have an increasing likelihood of landing more sales with each email sent with absolute certainty that there are people seeing your content and showing interest in it.

Funnel lay outs that you can try are: Organic Lead Gen Strategies

Sales

A lead magnet is what draws the attention of readers, the copywriting used is what hooks the audience with great messaging and a funnel is what channels the reader's interest into **sales**. Sales is fundamentally the most valuable skill after copywriting, because the better you get at sales, the more money you're inclined to make. Sales is not about finding the quickest way to have someone buy something, sales is about:

- **Communication**: A salesperson should adopt the ability to communicate with people/potential clients in an effective manner to understand their wants, needs, challenges and losses. A salesperson should be able to communicate both verbally and on text with clients to keep them engaged in a concise way.

- **Relationship Building**: A salesperson must develop the ability to foster relationships with both potential clients and existing clients. A salesperson is required to be able to trust and be trusted, and be able to connect with clients on a personal level. Nothing too intimate, all that's required are strong relationships that compel potential clients to buy based on personal favor… Though this is not to say you should fake your relationships, keep them genuine.
- **Persuasion**: As a sales person, one must be able to persuade a client/prospect into making a purchase. This is achieved by understanding the clients wants and needs, and presenting the product or service in a way that shows that it can fulfill those wants and needs.
- **Negotiation**: Sometimes a potential client is not willing to make a purchase right off the bat, which requires the sales person to be able to negotiate with the person to find mutual benefit, thus leading to a purchase.
- **Problem Solving**: As someone who's selling a product or service to a client, a salesperson should have the ability to solve the clients problems. By understanding the obstacles and challenges the client faces, a sales person can come up with a viable solution to solve their problem, but also alludes to a sale.

Sales is a difficult yet highly rewarding skill, because without it, your business probably won't be making any sales, or that you won't be making as many sales as you could be. From exploring topics such as opening and closing, sales is one of those skills that you'll never stop learning new things about, as it's an evolving market space of its own.

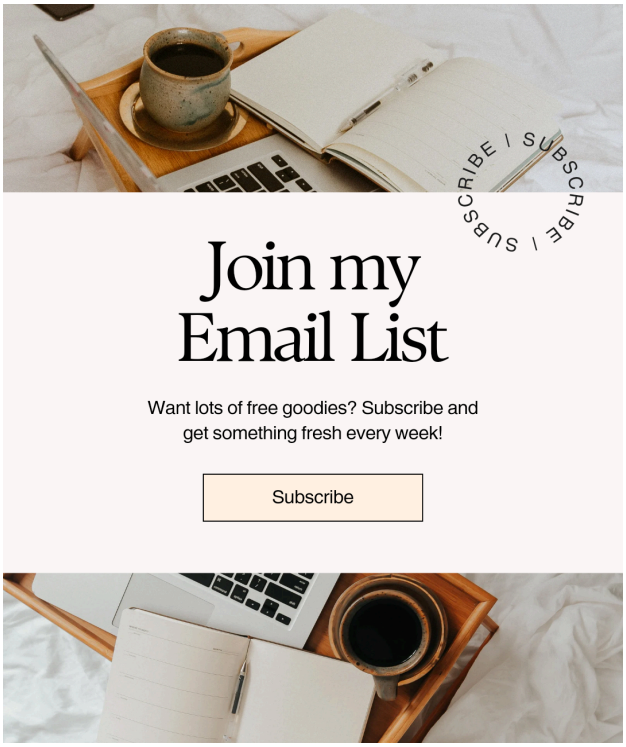
The ability to sell is what builds or breaks a business. Though it is essential to learn sales and how to apply the knowledge to land a sale, this skill is more important for service based businesses compared to produce based services. Reason being that products tend to be cheaper and services are more experienced on average, which means customers who are looking to purchase services online may tend to be wary, untrusting and doubtful, which means there should be someone at the end of your business's telephone ready to make calls and land a sale.

Famous South African speaker and entrepreneur, *Vusi Thembekwayo*, likes to use the phrase "**Burn the line**". What he meant by this, is that from your opening hours till close, make calls viciously and relentlessly in aim to land sales, and for service based businesses, this is the 1st and only thing the business owner should be focusing on, because a business is not a business without sales. Without sales calls to drive revenue, then the website copy, business card and online presence will have very little effect, especially when you're fresh out of the box and are starting out.

For this reason, good sales skills are necessary to get your business off the ground.

Email List

Building an email list is highly important, it's your means of collecting your visitors' contact information to get back to them if they didn't make a purchase. Email lists are generally valuable on their own, as you can sell them for tens of thousands, hundreds of thousands or even millions of dollars to large companies depending on the niche and quality of your leads.



Creating an email list is easy, and is free for the most part. Essentially what happens is that you ask your followers to subscribe to your email list/newsletter for something in return, perhaps a free download or weekly content that they'd like to read. By regularly sending out emails to your email list, the higher the open rate will be, and this will translate to a higher quality email list that you can sell your current or future products to.

You can use services like:

1. MailChimp
2. Beehive
3. Klaviyo
4. GetResponse
5. ClickFunnel

Just to name a few, and each email provider has their own terms of use that you have to read through. MailChimp will require you to pay them monthly while the rest are mostly free, with Klaviyo giving more functionality in the free plan.

With your email list, you'll have to use your sales and copywriting skills to build a sales funnel within your email list, and this is called email marketing. While you give updates on your business to your leads, make engaging content and maybe even feature them in your content you're free to run sales, give coupon codes and promotions too. Ideally, you'll want to set up an abandoned cart campaign so that when a customer forgets to make a purchase, they'll get an email reminder to make the purchase.

Statistically speaking, email is the best channel to reach and engage with your leads/audience. On average, social media platforms will have less than 20% of your followers see your content, which is why most semi large accounts on social media get low engagement and reactions despite their big following. Email on the other hand, 100% of your subscribers get your emails, and the open rate largely depends on how your content is structured. If you're able to engage with your subscribers in a meaningful way, your open rate will increase, whereas if you make emails to promote something, your emails will be labeled as spam and your overall open rate will drop drastically.

This makes email an amazing marketing platform, because for every $1 spent on email marketing you'll get between $30 and $44 back. Though this statement does contradict the one I made earlier about not promoting things in your email, it still holds true. You can make a lot of money from email, you just have to avoid being salesy. People want to buy, but they hate being sold, and it doesn't matter how good your product or service is, people won't buy or even be interested if they can smell that you're trying to sell them something.

Getting It Delivered

Now, before even considering the format or template you're going to use to send your emails, you'll 1st have to know if your email will reach your email list. There are honestly just a few things to consider, and all of them stem from the company you choose to send your email. Whether you choose to use:

1. MailChimp
2. HubSpot
3. ActiveCampaign
4. InfusionSoft

It's highly advised that you take a look at their reviews and reputation. You want to have a look at what others are saying about the company, primarily the ISP Score, the inboxing and deliverability. You want your emails to reach your subscribers without issue, which means you'll just have to do a little research on these companies to see which is the best fit for you.

Another thing you should look at is your Bounce rate and complaints. What this means is the number of emails that get sent back , and this is usually due to fake emails being put in when you're collecting a large number of emails. Complaints are from when someone opens your

emails and leaves a complaint/bad review because they didn't enjoy the experience from having to open your emails. Make sure to avoid the both of them, because your Bounce rate and accumulated complaints alert the ISP and identify you as someone who's probably not legit, and in turn this will greatly damage your deliverability, as more and more of your emails will not reach your subscribers, which is why double authentication is important.

Getting It Opened

Imagine for a moment that it's early in the morning. You just woke up and have a fresh cup of coffee with you, to which you grab your phone and open your email… What's the 1st thing you do? What most people do, is that they scroll through their email, checking off emails that they don't want to read to delete them, and archive emails that they find unimportant. The reason for this is largely because the emails received are from businesses and companies that send out corporate advertising material. Again, people don't like to be sold, and we've grown to ignore everything that's too salesy and/or is not for our best interest.

The emails that get opened are usually from friends and family. These emails are usually less formal, have less formatting and are personal. What you'll want to do is make your emails more personalized, which can be tricky in the world of business.

Usually, upon receiving a sales email, the thing that has you know that it's a sales email is the subject line. Companies tend to capitalize every word they type, *It Makes Reading The Email Feel Way Too Formal*, and some may even write their subject lines in *ALL CAPS*. There are those who try to stand out or try to be cute by using emojis, and unfortunately, most people can see through the intent and just skip the email entirely. When friends send you an email, it often lacks grammar and formatting. When my friends send me an email, it's usually text that reads:

"*hey, check this out"*
Or
"*You won't wanna miss this*"

You're free to talk about exactly what the email is about within your subject line, just make sure your subject line doesn't sound commercial or else the chances of your email being opened will drop.

Provide Value

When someone opens your email, and your copy is dry, with you trying to shove an offer down their throat, they'll have distaste for your emails. When someone receives more of your emails, over time they'll say things such as "*I already know what this email is about, I'm not ready to buy anything right now*." then instantly, your email will be sent into the archives.

On the other hand, let's say you bombard your readers with value; every email sent is engaging, you entertain the reader and keep them well educated on something, they'll naturally want to see more and more of your emails. The 1st few emails you send set the tone of your email open rate, and if your emails are good, your subscribers will get a little dose of dopamine when they see your email, prompting them to open it to have a read.

When you take a look at the open rates of most businesses, the 1st day the open rate is highest, the 2nd day the open rate drops a little and on the 5th day their open rates are dead. That's because they're not looking to provide value and engage with the reader, and once you have your readers want to read more of your emails, your open rates increase.

Content Creation Strategies

These days, people have begun doing background checks on whoever is looking to sell something to them. If you're building a brand and you're selling your own products and services, make sure to build a vast online presence along the way to build discoverability, authority and an increasing following. This is so that when people do a background check on you, they'll be able to type your name on Google and have articles about you pop up, allowing them to recognize you as an expert in the field.

Now, understand that I'm not saying become a celebrity, influencer or someone with a large following. What I'm saying is that you have built an online presence, created awareness and created a source of traffic for your business that compounds over time. Once you've figured out what you're going to sell, it all becomes a numbers game.

Content creation isn't easy, especially when you're starting out. You'll be tempted to wait until you have the perfect product to sell, the perfect equipment to start creating content and the perfect niche to start selling into… & the reality is that they'll never happen. I started selling this book back when it only had 9 pages with 5 chapters as the book was a “*quick guide*”, I didn't have a clue about what copywriting is, was selling it on Patreon despite not having a following on Patreon nor without any traffic to speak of. I was basically a baby when I first started, and I had to start regardless, improving ever so slightly with each progression and building the experience. This is the 4th and final update of the book, and I hope it has you realize that you don't have to be a pro or have anything perfect happening, you'll have to build everything from scratch, and content creation is the fastest way to do that.

There are 2 ways to start creating an online presence fast, without having a following.

Video

Video content is by far the most consumed form of content, and the demand for it is increasing. This means that video is probably the best way to build authority and make sales online because viewers get to know you and your brand through the way you articulate. YouTube is pushing the algorithm to give attention to new coming channels, so this is among the best times to get started with video content.

Now, we're in an age where TikTok has shortened the attention span of viewers, with its trendy features, music and attention grabbing content, it's becoming increasingly difficult to get eyes on your videos. This is the market you'll be competing against, and in order for you to stand out from the crowd, you must understand that your content should:

Grab Attention: Write a good hook to get people listening. The more people stop to watch what your video is about, the more your video will be pushed in front of more eyes, essentially increasing the views your content gets.

Be Relevant: Your content should have relevance to the viewer within the niche you're in. If your content is not relevant, it will get low likes, which will signify low engagement and thus will kill the performance of your content.

Be Relatable: The content you flush out should be relatable to the viewer and many others of similar interest, and if it is, it will get shared to other people.

Add Value: Most social media content is just noise and distraction, not much value can be extracted from it, which usually results in low saves. Add value to your content that you know is helpful and actionable, prompting viewers to save your video for later because they may need the info in the future.

Make sure to have optimized your profile for the type of audience you're trying to attract, which will help boost the number of followers you have .

Due to being new to the space and not knowing what content will perform well, have a look at the comment section of accounts within your niche that have a large following.

1. Read the requests and the addressed problems, of which you'll make a list of.
2. For each request or problem, make a 4 to 6 minute video talking about the issue, use 2 to 3 minutes talking about the issue and 2 to 3 minutes talking about the solution
3. Go back to the comments telling them that maybe your video will help them out, they should take a look
4. Use AI to split your video into short form content to post in TikTok, Reels, YouTube shorts and LinkedIn to build awareness with links leading to your channel
5. Rinse and repeat

This is the early stage of your channel, so instead of trying to go viral, your focus should be to train the YouTube algorithm to know which kind of audience to send to your channel. Due to a few eyes seeing your content straight out the bat, YouTube will assume your content holds value, hence it will be favored by the algorithm.

Do this for a minimum of 3 months, you're free to add longer forms of content if you wish, and stay consistent. This method is effective because you'll be building authority, solving real problems, getting a following and getting views posting relatively short content that won't take you more than 10m to create. You'll be able to create large amounts of content in a short time period because you wouldn't be spending hours on a video without even knowing if people like it or not. After 3 months, your YouTube and social media channels would have received enough data to know who to push your content in front of.

While doing this, create 1 video after every 5 videos discussing your product at the end of the video and putting links on the video description to send traffic to your website, basically allowing you to create an income stream while building your following.

Blog

A blog is the 2nd best way to bring traffic to your business even when without a following or traffic. You'll have the flexibility to post numerous blog articles that rank for different topics within your brand, allowing you to draw traffic from Google search organically.

It is worth mentioning that within your niche, choose topics that are relevant to your niche but aren't the same, this will allow you to have a vast option of topics to discuss instead of limiting yourself. Also, make it a point that you choose a niche you know well, something you can write 100 blog posts about this year and still be able to maintain that momentum for the future.

Now, you 1st have to understand what a blog is. Blogs are mediums of information and transactions, when someone wants a review on something or a comparison of products, a blog article is what they'll be most likely to read. When people are looking to make purchasing decisions they use blogs to help streamline their choices, and with a few affiliate links added to your article you can make additional revenue on top of the money you'll be making with your products or services.

Google tends to down vote blogs that are too transactional, which means you have to include informative content into your blog. The advice ratios are 70 informative articles and 30 transactional articles (7:3) or 80 informative articles and 20 transactional articles (8:2). This all boils down to your preference and the niche you're in.

Simple products such as camping equipment, clothing, watches, gardening equipment etc, require less informative articles, 20 informative posts per 50 transactional posts would perform well for this niche. Within the wealth, finance, health, accounting and etc, services or products,

you'll need the 7:3 or 8:2 ratio in order to build the necessary topical authority. For gardening all your sites can rank on the 1st page in a week or less, while for finance your site may rank on the 1st page after 10 years… There are different layers of competitiveness for each topic, which is why it'd be a wise idea to start with low search volume and low competition keywords so that you can get those early wins and have your blog posts rank.

Over time you'll add more competitive keywords, increasing your website traffic in the process. What you can do is post updates about your articles on Threads, Facebook and 𝕏 to increase the traffic ever so slightly. How your blog post ranks is entirely dependent on SEO, which stands for search engine optimization, you'll read more about it later in the book.

The different websites that you can use to write your blog are:

1. WordPress.com
2. WIX
3. Ghost
4. Blogger
5. SquareSpace
6. Tumblr
7. WordPress.org

Of course there are many other platforms you can use to start your blog, however these are among the best. I advise you to do research on each of these services and see which one best fits your objective.

Social Media Growth

Growing on social media is another highly beneficial endeavor. E-commerce functionality within social media platforms has become a thing, and is growing in popularity. It's a no-brainer that to grow on social media you'll need to post occasionally and over time you'll have an increase in engagement. Likewise, you could search up how the algorithm works for the platform you're on and optimize your content for the given platform. As such, I'm not going to dedicate this section to "*secret tactics to unlock fast growth*", rather I'll be focusing on how to build a following that's likely to convert, allowing you to make sales even with a ridiculously low following or no following at all.

LinkedIn

It's no mystery that LinkedIn is a business platform, designed to network employers with employees, connect professionals and have B2B businesses find their clients. It's gaining popularity as a new platform to become a content creator, and for good reason.

Obviously, less than 1% of the millions of users on LinkedIn make content, and only a few of them are good at it while others just push terrible content. Another thing to mention is that

LinkedIn is becoming more casual, with professional mannerism deteriorating due to the new generation slowly taking over.

Another shocking fact is that most people on the platform aren't experts, meaning there's a massive market that you can educate on LinkedIn without having to be concerned about making viral content. LinkedIn has the highest household income of all platforms, which means that you can find clients for your product or service and many of them will be able to afford it.

LinkedIn is a community based platform, the algorithm isn't interest based like all other social media platforms. This means that your content gets pushed to the kind of people you interact with, you could have 1 post yet still get a large following. That's because you're more likely to get more followers by commenting and engaging in posts with other users, solidifying your expertise and so others will connect with you because they'll view you as a valuable contact to have.

With the posts you made, always reply to your comments, address peoples worries and refer them to your product or service if they're a match. With a good mix of posts and commenting, your account will grow really fast in a short amount of time while you can be certain that you'll be getting traffic to your product.

𝕏
The platform 𝕏 (formally Twitter) is another fantastic platform to grow on without being all that concerned about having a large following. Posting in a community can land you thousands of impressions in a day, and optimizing your profile can result in an increase in following.

Though posting and replying to comments is a sure fire way to get more engagement, it's not necessarily the fastest way to grow on 𝕏. There is a feature that you should take advantage of, which is Space. Spaces are like mini podcasts, fitting the app because 𝕏 is a micro blogging platform. You can join spaces hosted by other entrepreneurs within your area of expertise, you're guaranteed to find a large number of listeners in a space. Do what you can to catch the hosts attention, get them to call you out or give you the chance to speak… and with the platform, you're essentially using the hosts credibility as your own, and whatever you choose to say will impact whether you'll be called in for another space or not. More importantly, the more you're able to engage in spaces, the greater the traffic you send to your profile, many of which will tap on the link on your bio… & if you were well spoken, the traffic may just turn into inbound clients.

Go to communities, ask and answer questions, help people solve their problems and you'll build an engaged following filled with warm leads waiting for the que to make a purchase. 𝕏 is easily one of those platforms where you can make $1K+ a month without a big following.

Instagram
Instagram is a platform where you can go from 0 followers to 10K followers in 4 months with the right approach. Plus you can be sure that your followers are always updated about your content

because they receive notifications whenever you post, and your content is among the 1st they'll see on their feed.

Now, growth on Instagram is almost entirely dependent on the quality of videos you're able to produce, and with highly entertaining content on the platform, you'll be faced with tough competition. As such, you should use AI tools such as ManyChat to help engage with your audience as much as possible.

The goal of your content should be to have the audience comment a given word on your post, leading to the AI sending them a message in their inbox, allowing you and them to engage. The AI can handle conversations for you, and this often results in high convergence and sales without you having to directly interact with the prospect.

Facebook
Facebook is easily the most popular and most recognized social media platform. This also means that it's the most overused platform, what this means is that the reach and engagement of posts is often low.

Though, because of the large database of users, businesses are still making a good load of money by using the platform.

I advise you to take the same approach as you would on LinkedIn and 𝕏, interact with your audience in the comment section and refer them to your product whenever possible. Due to the casual nature of the platform, sending them to a sign up form or a page to warm them up is a better alternative, because people on Facebook hardly have "*make a purchase*" floating somewhere in their thoughts.

The point of using social media in your business is not to get millions of followers, rather, it's to get the traffic you receive to concerts as much as possible.

Remember, you're still new to the game, so you'll have to work like a mad man in order to land your 1st few sales. You'll have to post to build credibility and authority, engage with people to show you want to help and over time they'll be warmed up to you enough to buy anything you have to offer.

SEO

SEO, a term you should know within the world of digital business. SEO stands for *Search Engine Optimization*. All online businesses need SEO to send traffic to their websites, and this is achieved by using searched keywords in their copy, site title and meta description, which all show up on Google's feed.

Now, it's worth mentioning that you should study SEO. Much like Copywriting, SEO is a topic of its own and has entire books written about it. It's not a must to know everything about SEO, though it is important to know the fundamentals. This section is dedicated to having you know the basic essentials of SEO, and the free tools you can use in your keyword research.

Keyword research: Refers to the act of researching commonly used terms and phrases within your niche. These keywords are then sorted by search intent and the competitiveness of the given term. The act of doing keyword research is to find words that people are searching on Google that aren't difficult to rank for.

If I were to type "*Dog*" on Google, a list of websites talking about dogs would appear. On this list are different websites of varying topical authority on Google, and because dogs have been around for a long time, it'll be difficult to rank this word as a new blog/website. On the other hand, if I were to search "*Dogs with pink hair exercise routine*", there won't be that many sites ranking for it, and the ones ranking for it aren't big shot websites with large topical authority, so if I were to make a blog about "Dogs with pink hair exercise routine" I have a higher likelihood of ranking in the 1st page of Google, and this is due to the phrase having low competition.

What determines a words competitiveness is how many people search for the term and which websites are writing about the topic. The words that are most competitive are usually covered by well established websites that will easily rank on the 1st page due to their topical authority. Realistically, you won't be able to rank for the same topic as Forbes, and that's because your websites hold different levels of authority… Forbes spent years and millions of dollars to be a figure of authority on many topics, so a new blog will have to look for other keywords to rank for.

In a nutshell, SEO is using keywords to have your website or blog to rank on Google search. Keyword research is a method of finding the words that will allow your blog or website to rank. Here's are a few websites you can use for your keyword research:

Answer The Public
Answer the public is a website where you can search a word or phrase within your niche and it'll generate numerous keywords and phrases related to your chosen word or phrase. The platform only allows for 3 free searches a day, though it's a powerful tool you can use to find what people are searching for in your niche. It will provide you with preposition keywords, comparison keywords, it will provide suggested questions for your keywords, give a table where all listed answers are arranged alphabetically and it'll even give you a list of related keywords.

ahrefs Keyword Generator
ahrefs is a paid SEO tool, though they have a list of free tools for the public to use, and their keyword generator is one of those tools. Keyword Generator allows you to type in a keyword or phrase, select the country you want to get traffic from and it'll give a listing of related keywords, the search volume for these given keywords and the competitiveness of these keywords. They

use color coding and numbering for you to know how competitive words are, a score of 80 signifies a high competitiveness while a score of 20 signifies low competitiveness. This tool will allow you to know which keywords to use for your blog and how it'll perform.

While SEO is commonly associated with Google search, SEO applies to all search engines. Whether it be:

1. Pinterest
2. 𝕏
3. Facebook
4. Instagram
5. LinkedIn
6. YouTube

These platforms have their own SEO that people search for. In the case of Pinterest, 𝕏, Facebook, Instagram and YouTube, they are able to appear in Google's organic search as well.

By optimizing your profile, you'll be able to generate traffic from within the social media app you're using. Furthermore, by adding relevant keywords to your content, you'll have your content rank within the social media platform and on Google, increasing your reach even further.

The types of SEO I recommend you study are:

1. Google SEO
2. Pinterest SEO
3. Instagram SEO
4. YouTube SEO

These will give you the best bang for your buck, and are easy to set up once you understand how things work.

Getting Featured

One of the best ways to drive traffic to your business is to be featured on someone's blog, podcast, YouTube channel, etc. This can come in the form of an interview or them talking about you, and having them make a blog post about your website is a fantastic way to build that passive source of traffic.

The reason why this method is so effective is because the more blog posts and websites that have links leading to your website, the more authoritative Google will perceive your website, hence you'll rank higher.

Another reason is that you'll be funneling the traffic of the individual featuring you, and if they have a large traffic, then expect a drastic spike in the number of visits you get on your website and potentially even the sales on your product or service.

It begs the question "*How do I get started?*", and the answer is a pretty simple solution, though it may prove to be a tedious task.

You can 1st start by searching on 𝕏 for bloggers within your niche. Engage with their content to build familiarity and try to read out in DM. If you can't get through, go to the link on their bio, it usually leads to their blog or website, to which you'll search for their email and send them an email requesting a collaborative blog post. Make sure to go for individuals with a medium to small following and decent traffic to their site, they're more likely to respond and are less likely to charge a fee.

Another method would be to search on YouTube for creators who are still new in the space and try to get their email. Once you've got it, ensure that they're still posting regularly… and if they are, send them an email asking for a collaborative video, podcast or vlog.

Do these kinds of reach outs for at least an hour a day, someone will respond eventually. Produce your own content in order to have the proper appeal to make the request, and the better your content the higher the likelihood that you'll be accepted.

You may lead in by offering to feature their content in yours, have your DM or email be a notification that you'll be featuring the said individual, and hopefully they'll be more inclined to feature you in their content.

Why people buy

There's a common term used in business, especially in marketing, known as *WIIFM*, which means *what's in it for me?* Regardless of what business you start, that's the number 1 question to ask yourself through the perspective of the client. If your product or service does no fulfill an interest, desire or mitigate a problem, then it doesn't matter how good or fancy the product is, you won't make any sales.

This *WIIFM* concept is a trait of thinking people naturally possess, we use it to filter out what's relevant to us from the rest, and oftentimes it's emotionally triggered.

A product on it's own won't sell, it has to include:

1. **An emotional value proposition**: Meaning the product has to have something that triggers a customer emotionally to have them believe that your price is a bargain. People

are able to make coffee at home yet still go to StarBucks, not because the coffee is better, but because of the customer experience and personalized delivery.
2. **A clearly defined outcome**: The outcome paired with an emotional trigger is a powerful way to have potential clients view you as the professional that can help them reach their desired goal. It may be simple, and it is common knowledge, but in this day and age, common knowledge is no longer common practice.
3. **Develop a success story around the product or service**: One crucial aspect that separates the success or winners and losers in business, is that winners have a way relating to the customers pain points and reflecting it through a story. This builds bonds and trust with clients, while also having them genuinely believe that your product or service is for them because it has given results. Even if you have no story, you are the customer avatar, make a story on how your product or service has helped you, any sign that your product works will produce significant results.

Knowing this will separate you from all the competitors who just make a list of products and services to then **hope** someone buys. People are not dumb, they don't just buy random things for no reason, that is a reality you'll have to accept.

When creating a product, ask yourself these questions:

1. **Why**: Why make this product? Why is it useful? Why should anyone take a moment of their time to take a look at it? Once you're able to find solid answers to these questions, you'll also encounter the emotional reasons and triggers that you can use to grab your customers' attention.
2. **How**: How will this product or service be delivered? How will the product or service help the client? How will the product or service be distributed to the market? You should make it a priority to create your product or service in a way that's easy to deliver to your clients, in a manner that solves the problem in the least complicated yet most satisfactory way possible, and in a way that will position you in front of more potential clients.
3. **What**: What should be done to get the results? What should be done to make the customer happy? What should the customer do? These are outcome driven questions that many people tend to start with, do the opposite. The intention is to draw the client in, starting with “what” will lead you to talk about the technicalities without the client even knowing the “why they should be interested”, the “how will this help them” and the overall WIIFM, leading you to lose customers.

3 Primal Desires

To best position yourself in an evergreen environment, you can take advantages of 1 of the 3 primal needs of humans, which fall within the categories of:

1. Wealth
2. Health

3. Relationships

People will always use an exchange medium such as money, people want to be rich, people want to be fit and healthy, people want stable relationships that last.

The niche you're in is not a limiting factor, you could sell watches and enter a subcategory of watches that track the wearers heart-rate, a watch that's linked to a dating app etc. Sometimes, people just want to be perceived as successful, so sell luxury watches to appeal to their desires. These 3 desires are things you can use to yourself from the competition because they are never out of season.

What I recommend is that you double down on one of these 3 desires, make them a part of your brand, and in this era the demand for all 3 will increase. The cost of living as skyrocketed so high that almost everyone below $20K a month is forced to find alternative ways to make money or risk losing their livelihoods, making wealth an increasingly evergreen market for example. On the other side of the coin, there are people who wish to seem wealthy, as such you should create products and services to cater to them, you can label this line of products as “Luxury” or “Premium” and you'll attract customers who aren't afraid to spend money.

Health is the most diverse and lucrative niche in my opinion, for there are numerous subcategories that you can take advantage of.

Available markets are:

1. Weight loss
2. Strength training
3. Speed training
4. Fitness
5. Diet

Alongside 50+ other categories. What this means is that in whatever niche you're in and whatever product you sell, there may be a health based version you can sell. If you sell clocks, you can include a vegetable or diet based clock in your collection. If you sell shoes or clothing, you can incorporate fitness products in your line of clothing. Basically for every physical product sold, a health based variant can be applied.

Relationships are the most flexible niche, because you can take advantage of nearly every holiday, most importantly being:

1. Valentine's Day
2. Workers Day
3. Mother's Day
4. Father's Day
5. Christmas
6. Halloween

Within this niche, you're able to identify what will be in trend at which date, allowing you to prepare a line of products that are highly likely to sell. A course on how to network and get connected can be made, a guide to find love or a simple Merry Christmas card, all can sell pretty well and generate a ton load of money.

6 Human Needs (identity and etc)

This may sound repetitive, but it's a mantra you should never forget. People *don't buy products or services, they buy feelings, they buy stakes, they buy an identity, they buy stories and they buy outcomes*. That's solely because all purchases are made under the criteria of 6 Human needs, which are:

1. **Certainty**: Everyone wants certainty, they want to know that their problems will be solved, and ideally if they can get pleasure or relaxation.
2. **Uncertainty (variety)**: Too much certainty may lead to boredom, which is why a variety of ways to achieve goals for the client is necessary. An element of surprise will exist, keeping the client engaged in an environment where their needs can still be met.
3. **The need to feel significant**: People want to feel unique, valued and important. Brands like Nike, Apple and Coke have created an ecosystem where their customers are being celebrated, which has built strong brand loyalty.
4. **Connection**: Humans are social, even introverts need someone to talk to every once in a while. The need to connect is powerful, it's what the success of social media apps like Facebook and Instagram are built on. If you can manage to build a community around your business and have these like-minded individuals connect, you'll have an ecosystem of a connected customer community that keeps coming back.
5. **Growth**: People have an innate desire to grow, to improve on something within their life. Deliver anything that helps accelerate their growth within a certain area in life and keep expanding on it, you'll earn their trust and loyalty.
6. **Contribution**: Many people in the world love to contribute to others, they want to help and be a part of something. If you can manage to create a business community where you and your customers contribute to each other's growth, you'll have a business with a high growth potential.

Each of these 6 needs can be used individually to build a business, or be used interchangeably. Such as with significance, people tend to associate higher value and higher importance with higher price, meaning that it's possible to land high paying clients by adding a form of significance to your offer.

A very solid way to explain how all these 6 needs can be met in a brand is to take a look at Nike.

1. Their products make customers certain of the quality and performance of the clothes.
2. There's always a level of uncertainty around what new product is coming out and its design.
3. Nike praises their athletes as heroes, they help the underdogs become winners and this helps new coming athletes feel significant.
4. Nike has built a brand of go-getters, as such, those who wear Nike tend to connect with other Nike fans.
5. Nike drives the initiative of growth in always finding ways to reward improvement and self betterment.
6. Nike has a large following, of which many people help others within the community, creating an ecosystem of athlete's willing to help other athletes grow, and this contribution helps the athletes fall in love with what they do.

The way I managed to achieve a similar effect was to create a fitness motivation Pinterest account which had pins that lead to blog posts. On these blog posts would be affiliate links to Amazon fitness products, and within the blogs were comments for people to connect and talk. What I failed to realize is that because I put affiliate links on every blog, the content became too sales driven and eventually that killed the trust people had with my content, leading to a drop in engagement, to a point where the blog itself became unsustainable. I focused so much on my growth that the visitors of my blog began feeling used, and the key takeaway is that you should consider finding ways to connect with your leads and help them grow without any monetization schemes involved. Create a community where people contribute to each other and have 30% to 40% of your content be transactional while the rest should be there to build trust and return customers.

Let's say you sell watches for example, you could add "*Reaching Riches*' ' as your slogan, and as people make purchases, try to find information about some of the successful and wealthy customers you've had. Create occasional featured posts in your email newsletter discussing these people's accomplishments and how they reach their riches. This will not only motivate those who aspire to build their own riches, but it will also encourage those who are already successful feel acknowledged, and those not featured may try to get recognized by you. This will create a brand that inspires others to become wealthy, thus justifying any price tag you choose. There'll be uncertainty around what watch you'll release next, but there'll be certainly that you'll deliver a quality product, prompting the incentive of returning customers… which is just one of the many ways this can be done.

Solve Problems Within A Market Gap

For a moment, think about how there are so many car companies, think about the many cell phone companies, etc. One common thing they all have is that they did not try to reinvent the wheel, they chose what worked, expanded on it and just tweaked it to fit a certain problem within a certain market.

the iPhone creates devices for creative individuals who want to express themselves, Samsung just probably makes phones for people who want high quality phones. Then there's Xiaomi, a company that creates phones for poor countries. They realized that there are countries that needed phones but couldn't afford them, and so Xiaomi found its market.

Point is, there are already thousands of people selling what you're looking to sell as a start up, so look for a small market segment where there's a problem that has not yet been addressed, then create solutions. An example is of how dating apps exist, yet there isn't an app for wealthy people who are specifically looking to date photographers… It sounds insane, but a genius strategy can make it work.

Another way to do it, is to sell the exact same product as everyone else, and deliver the product or service in a way no one else does, preferably in a manner that makes solving the customer's problems as easy as possible.

Let's say you teach people how to do their nails, what you can do is join a community of people who are interested in beauty tips. You can start by creating a blog that's a step by step guide on how to get a certain look for a given set of nails, and below the blog post you can put up a CTA to book a coaching session with you. Within the community, create a short post which will either be in text, image or video format, and in this post you'll give a brief summary on how to get the nails done with an illustration of how the nails will look, below the short post being an link to the blog and a clear CTA telling people who are interested in knowing how to get the nails done to tap on the link to learn more. This would be a simple example of how you'd build interest and awareness about your brand in a community of individuals who are actively searching for said services, and packaging it in a manner that's easy to consume, attracts quality leads to your blog and makes it really easy for them to purchase your services when need be.

Sell To A Hungry Audience

Ask yourself, how hungry is your target audience? How hungry are they to solve their problems? In most cases, the products sold don't have to be the best in the area. You can have the best hot dogs and make less sales compared to someone who makes bad hot dogs yet has found an area filled with hungry people.

Where you position yourself is best. Online, if you sell recipes, it'll be best to place yourself in front of chefs. If you sell games, join a community of gamers; if you sell gym courses, join a community of gym rats, etc. The key takeaway here is that you should avoid joining communities that specifically represent what you do, eg. If you affiliate market games, do not join affiliate marketing groups and hope to make sales; if you sell courses, don't sell in groups that were designed to have people post about their courses.

A lot can be said, if you sell household products, join a community of home renovators and interior design. Join communities of people who actively search for (and use) the kinds of products and services you offer.

Product vs Distribution vs Ecosystem

To every successful business there's a product and there's distribution, and only a few have an ecosystem. 1st time entrepreneurs solely focus on the product, they want to make sure that it's perfect and that it's the best in the market, which is good, but it shouldn't be the sole priority, because what's the point of maxing out your product if you don't max out your distribution?

Good distribution will always beat a good product, ***always.*** Reason being, distribution gets the product in front of customers, the better your ability to distribute your product, the more sales you'll make. Though I do encourage you to make your product as good as possible, make sure that your distribution strategy is even better, 10x better is probably the bare minimum if you're looking to scale.

Though distribution is key to success, there exists another aspect that holds greater weight, which is an ecosystem. Creating an ecosystem is like creating a building where all customers and potential customers can live, and whenever you have a new product you'll be able to pitch it to them without having to spend money on advertising. An ecosystem can come in the form of an email list for a newsletter, a WhatsApp group, a discord channel or anything that will allow you to communicate with all your supporters because they're the most likely to return, which will have their numbers compile, generating greater wealth over time.

Let's say there are 2 entrepreneurs who sell cell phones, named Jack and Sam. The cellphone market in their area has 100 cell phones purchased every month. Now, Jack works to maximize the quality of his phones, while Sam works to build an ecosystem around his product through a community app and thus makes phones specifically for creative people. Due to Jack's phones being more appealing to the general public, he manages to distribute his phone to 60% of the market with phones worth $40; while Sam manages to distribute to 40% of the market with phones worth $80 that his customers are more than happy to pay for. Jack's business makes $2,400 a month while Sam's business makes $3,200 a month. Though Jack had a better phone and better distribution, he still made less money compared to Sam because he failed to build an ecosystem.

A strong business has all 3 aspects, though distribution and ecosystem are where all the money is, and it's far easier to make an ecosystem when focusing on a certain kind of customer within a market than when looking to provide for everyone. People will always be willing to pay an extra buck for something that they feel was designed specifically for them. With the example above, Jack will always have to advertise any new product, while Sam will only need to send messages through the community app to update everybody, which is cheaper. This should have some people immediately correlate the given example with Samsung and Apple.

This can be achieved for regular products and services, creating a free/paid membership or newsletter to keep your customers engaged and in touch with all updates, while creating content to keep people engaged whenever possible, because this small community will become your free source of revenue as time goes.

Do What's Required Not Your Best

Avoid making the mistake of attaching your effort into a product or service to the value it has. An easy way to put it, is that someone can make 100+ terrible videos promoting a product, to then be upset assuming something is wrong with them or their product, which isn't the case. This person worked hard on those videos, but the quality of work they produced wasn't on the required level where they'd get a potential customer interested enough to take a look at the product.

Identify each step of what's required to get your business up and running, then find ways to meet those requirements because doing your best simply isn't an option. This may sound intense and intimidating, but sometimes doing what's required is as simple as changing the sales script in one video to land a client.

Do not associate hard work with greater value, rather, associate client satisfaction with value. It'll open your mind to new ways of thinking, it'll allow you to detach yourself from the business and you'll be able to focus your efforts on the customers. Sometimes we tend to be hard on ourselves and try to put our best efforts in things we think add value, while what actually adds value is most likely something more simple and less demanding.

It's all about them, not you. Solve their problems, not what you think is worth solving, it'll make business a hundred times easier.

In instances where what's required exceeds your current ability, read books, develop skills along the way and simplify your product or service to a level that you can manage while you build toward the requirements you wish to fulfill.

The requirements for different things will clearly be different, and as a business owner you'll have to be able to reach the requirements for the things that'll drive the needle the most for your business. For example, if you have a product based business, understand that social media accounts have an average engagement of 4%, while the number is below 1% for larger accounts. On average, websites that perform well convert 9% to 15% of the traffic they receive into customers. To give a vague number, let's say your product is worth $50, and you want to make $1000 a month, which means you'll have to make 20 sales a month from the traffic from social media. With an engagement rate of 4% (assuming you don't have a large following), with less than 50% of the engaged audience clicking through your link, you'd have to generate 140 visits minimum to your website a month. The reality being that your posts may need hundreds or

thousands of views to generate the 140+ clicks to your website, and this is something you'll have to accept.

Study the platforms you use and the market you're in, get a look at the numbers and calculate the minimum number of visits your website will have to receive on a monthly basis, then plan your content and marketing strategy accordingly.

Market Value Needs

Each market has its own set of needs, which often means each market has a certain amount of money it's willing to pay and a level of value they need.

Let's say you find an economy that's in need of cars for transportation, and you begin designing cars for them. By spending your time and resources building Lamborghinis and Ferraris, you'll find yourself disappointed because they don't need luxury cars, they probably just need a family van and a couple of affordable Toyota's.

You have to make sure that your target market can afford your product, and whether they're willing to buy it. You probably wouldn't sell guns to babies, so don't look to sell luxury products to modest people or sell cheap products to rich people, you'll genuinely struggle to make sales.

Let's say you sell affiliate products around the camping niche, and your blog or website traffic is from regular Americans who enjoy the outdoors. Avoid products with fancy features like glow in the dark tents, rainbow flashlights etc, take a look at the basic needs of campers and work from there. Look for highly durable tents, insect nets, stainless steel knives and portal grills. Look for longer lasting charcoal, durable ropes and glow in the dark sticks, even longer battery life power banks would do.

Address what the market needs are and double down on the reasons and pain points behind them. Campers want tents, though not for aesthetics, but to stay safe while sleeping in the wilderness, so highly durable tents would be something attractive to sell. Everyone can bring a grill, though a lot of them are too big to carry, though they're still needed because people cook, so offering a portal grill gives them the desired benefit of being able to cook their meals without the hassle of carrying a large grill everywhere they go.

A large factor in how your traffic converts is rooted in your ability to identify their needs and leading them to a solution that best fits the outcome they wish to have without adding any unnecessary features. A glow in the dark tent is best fit for children who are doing some indoor camping, and marketing to them will be different from marketing to real campers, so you should know your market well.

Trust And Customer Referral

The best way to sell anything to anyone is through trust, and the only way to build trust with a large number of future customers is to become a key person of influence within your space. This means social media has to become a part of your toolkit, it's where you'll find a vast majority of your customers and is the best way to build authority.

Post quality content, even when you're just starting off, the social media platform will refer your content and account to individuals who are most likely to be interested in your content. It'll merely be a matter of patience and consistency, once people start sharing your content, your media and account will be shared to more people of similar interest, eventually leading to a passive compound effect where your account and business grow passively without the need to use money to market your business.

It's better to have a growing social media account than to market your product because you'll have a community of consumers who are engaged, trust you and are already most likely to purchase your products or services.

Pre-Launch Essentials

There's a term in business which is referred to as SOP, and what this stands for is *Standard Operation Procedures.* It really doesn't matter if you're a large, small or even a 1 person business, your business is a complex machine that must routinely get a specific set of actions completed within a given amount of time to maximize efficiency, reduce work friction and build overall stability within itself.

The best way to optimize this is through **systems**, and a good way to start identifying what systems you need or what systems even are, you 1st must know about the 3 basic pillars in every business.

1. **Customer Pillar**: Which is a part in your business where you look for customers. You can either freestyle your way through it or you can find certain steps and behaviors that consistently draw in customers for the purchase. This pillar is centered around marketing, sales and offboarding, which refers to the experience the customer had from their discovery of your product and after they've used it. A good and consistent customer pillar often results in return customers while a bad customer pillar usually results in bad reviews and stagnant sales.
2. **Product Pillar**: The heart of a business is its product, and when it comes to making a product or service, 3 things are involved. These 3 things are research & development, production and fulfillment. These 3 stages of making a product or service are a way to

understand the customers needs, create a solution and deliver it in a way that solves the problem.

3. **Business Pillar**: A business pillar is basically all the functions involved that make your business a business. This will include things such as operations, management, HR, legal, finance and purchasing aspects of the business. All these are essential for you to be able to optimally control the cash flow within your business while also maintaining a viable work environment for yourself or employees, in a manner that protects you legally and has the most amount of profit.

All these 3 pillars require systems for each of the functions within them, or else the business will be a rocky mess that may prove to be more of a liability than an asset. Proper systems set successful businesses apart from average or failing businesses, and now that the reasons why systems are so crucial (even for startups) let's go over what systems, operations and processes are.

Policies

Before having a system you must 1st have a set of policies, a few will do at the start.
Policies are basically a set of rules of things your business can, cannot, will and will not do.

These policies are driven by your business strategy, and is why a business plan is important. Developing a strategic plan and adopting a set of policies which guide you toward your end goal is a good way to keep yourself, the business and anyone who jumps on board in line with the business mission and objectives.

Quick examples are how Nike doesn't sell phones, how McDonald's doesn't sell cars, why KFC doesn't sell fish and why Tesla doesn't sell makeup. This is because policies have been placed about what the business will produce, how they'll produce it etc.

Your policy for example could be that you're an expensive brand, you don't compete on price hence you compete on value. You can further add that you don't do discounts or give promotional sales, rather, you spend all your time making sure each product is worth more than the price tag on a market standpoint, but still profitable nonetheless.

Process

Processes are easily defined as "*A set of step by step actions to get something done over and over again*". By this definition, when you have something that you do in your business that produces good results, you'll want to do it more and more, hopefully getting better at it with each use case scenario… As such, this set of actions now becomes a process.

You'll draft down a step by step guide on how to get each step of the process done, which may often lead to logic-gate thinking tactics such as if action A doesn't result in output 1 take action B, if output 2 doesn't match with goal 3 then take action C. It really boils down to how complex your system will grow to become, though always remember to prioritize simplicity and task efficiency over all else.

Perhaps you'll run a consulting business, as such, your client acquisition process may look like this:

1. Find a list of potential clients
2. Send out cold emails
3. Book a call
4. Use sales script to open
5. Send them over to a demo of the service to evaluate service quality and negotiate price
6. Close the deal
7. Send them to to schedule a date and time for the consulting service

This was a rough outline of a client acquisition process someone might use for their business, and though it has a few rough edges, a process can always be refined and improved for optimal performance.

For physical and digital products, the client acquisition process will different greatly from a service based business. The process is often less demanding financially, but may require more work. For products, the process will often follow this format:

1. Get your product niche or an affiliate product
2. Search low competition moderate traffic keywords related to the product
3. Make a blog solving a problem related to the product and input the proper SEO for the blog post
4. Make content on social media about the product across multiple channels (Facebook, Instagram, TikTok) and add links to the blog post or product page
5. Build an email list where you can write informative content that occasionally leads readers to your affiliate/product blogs
6. Engage with your audience to build trust and authority, as a way to get engagement on your social media posts in order for the posts to reach more people.

In the case of products, you and many others are selling the same thing, so you must build processes to outperform your competition, either by getting greater reach or by building greater trust with the audience.

System

A system is "*A collection of processes, software, people and interfaces that work together to get work done.*"

A process determines what should be done and a system determines what's needed for it to be done.
When you find the contacts of potential clients, figure out the software you'll use for that. When you book a call, which software are you going to use? Zoom? Google Meets? WhatsApp? Perhaps consider your payment methods, determine the best software for your business. Think about who will be sitting at the desk to make the sale, will it be you or someone else? What should they do and how should they do it? Your marketing works well, your client went from your promotional text and entered your sales page, what software is used and how is the user experience crafted.

All these coexist in a complex ecosystem, ultimately placed in a system that's easy to deliver and execute, allowing anyone to get into any desired position and get the job done as required. Though you're still at the starting point, make sure to craft your systems in a way that will allow your business to grow even when you're not around for the month or year, make sure the business works smoothly and as intended regardless of who sits on which desk, and create a consistent workflow.

Standard Operating Procedures

SOPs are detailed instructions on how to get a list of things done in a manner that's acceptable by the business standards.

Processes are a list of what to do, systems are a list of what's needed for processes to be done and SOPs are ways on how it should be done.

SOPs are the detailed instructions on how to execute processes.

Processes tell you to take action 1, then action 2 then action 3. SOPs tell you that in order to do action 1 you must do A, B, C and D, & that action 2 requires E, F and G to be completed.

SOPs have us do the same thing, in the same way, over the same period of time to produce the same consistent results that keep the business moving.

So if a process tells you to make a milkshake, then a burger and a side of fries, an SOP gives you the recipe for the milkshake and burger, and also tells you how long the fries should stay in the oil and how the food should be served. This way, the business can be automated and it doesn't matter if an employee is replaced, the business will produce the exact same results.

5 Essential SOPs

SOPs are essentially a set of rules your business follows to get things done to generate consistent results in the most efficient way. Starting an online business means that these SOPs are a must have, as you'll have to find ways to handle the traffic of clients and customers you'll be getting, allowing you to make money in the smoothest possible manner.

Client Acquisition And Fulfillment SOP: A client acquisition SOP mainly focuses on the onboarding and offboarding process your customer experiences. Try to have the experience feel as natural as possible, and don't keep it transactional, purely because it'll be in your best interest to have your customers grow fond of your brand rather than have them buy & never come back. This can be achieved by having keywords in how you greet them, keywords in how you describe your product or service, key mannerisms in how you communicate with them and how you'd like to say goodbye. By maintaining consistency, you'll build a brand that'll have your old customers refer your ideal client to you, which is why you can't “wing it”.

Employee SOP: Whether a team or an individual, an employee SOP is needed to have the person responsible for handling a task actually do it as you wish. At some point as you grow, you may or will adopt 3rd party assistance, whether it's a video editor or voice over person, having an employee SOP will tell them precisely how you'd like the job done and how it must be done. This is to ensure that all major and minor parts within that role are fulfilled in the manner that you desire, which will help maintain your systems and processes much more effortlessly. This can also help have you keep track of your tasks even as an individual running the business.

Customer Service SOP: In time, it can happen that a customer or client contacts you and your team with either a request or complaint, and within this instance you should have a customer service SOP. A process which you use to understand their needs, calm them down and come up with a solution that mutual and leaves the customer satisfied. A lack in customer service SOP structure puts your business at a high risk of getting low reviews, and though you can't make everyone happy, still focus some of your time to make sure that you make your business as appealing to as many people as possible. Even if something goes wrong, an SOP will help resolve the matter and everyone will forget about the issue, & on the other hand if a customer gets a bad experience they may not keep quiet about it and your business will suffer for it.

Marketing and Sales SOP: To make money, you'll need a marketing and sales SOP. From how you'll be generating leads, to how you'll convert these leads into sales and how you want your

messaging to be, all this has to be planned. You want to be able to analyze how well a certain marketing and sales SOP serves you, find ways to make improvements and just stick to systems and processes that consistently make you the most number of sales per month. This will especially be helpful once you stop being the one making the marketing and sales.

Financial Management SOP: One thing that is equally as important as running a successful business, is being able to manage your business finances so that you're able to keep the business running. This can come in the form of how you'd reinvest in your business, how business expenses are managed and how profits are handled. The big mistake we're all likely to make is celebrating our wins which most often leads to us using the money before paying off all the things that keep the business afloat, thus killing it. A finance SOP covers things which are around the lines of how you do invoicing, how you collect payment, how you do book keeping and all that, it's essentially a system of how money comes in and out of your business and what you've put in place to maintain this cash flow.

Getting The Wheel Turning

Once the business plan has been established, and you've managed to generate leads & even landed your 1st client; it becomes really important that you set up a management system that will ensure that the reputation of your business earns its first merit. Maintaining a business can be at times far more difficult than getting it off the ground, especially when you're handling your 1st client. Sometimes it happens that you generate leads, but fail to secure a client, or perhaps it's that you're not familiar with how you should engage with a client (and/or contractor) during the service period. Whichever it may be, it's still important that you find effective ways to navigate through the hurdles to come.

Below are a few Business Models that can be adopted and listed sneak peaks on how to manage them. The information provided is not in depth, meaning you're still required to do research on your selected business model and draft something that's best fit for your business. The information below is to provide a framework of understanding in regards to what would need to be done to have the business operate optimally, a small overview of how things work per listed model, this is for people who are still uncertain about which business model to choose.

Marketing Business/Agency

A marketing business or agency is a business model where ("you") the service provider markets the content, services and products of clients to large audiences on social platforms such as Google, Facebook, Twitter, Tik Tok, Instagram, Pinterest, LinkedIn and many others. The form of marketing used by these agencies are ads, and these ads can either be in text, video or image format based on the used platform.

Finding a Client

Finding a client for a Digital Marketing business or agency isn't the same as finding leads for a website or product to purchase. To find a client, business or agency owners must find ways to communicate with a client directly either through a cold call or cold email. The best approach is to do research on the client and try to see what they are struggling with, identify if your business has the skills to solve their problem or not and try to find the business owners number if possible. Set up questions which lead to a conversation that allows the potential client to talk about their problems and the ways they've tried to fix them, if any marketing issues arise, have them know that your business deals in marketing and that you may be able to help them solve their problem.

A cold call is an unexpected call to the client and a cold email is an email of you marketing your business to the client in hopes they click.
Cold calling and cold emails can take what feels like an endless streak of trial and error before landing your 1st zoom call. It can genuinely take 90 calls a month for 5 months or more to just land 1 zoom call or 2, that's the harsh reality of it, but that's what's needed to get your business going, it all boils down to your communication skills.

Once you're able to get a response from your leads, invite them to a zoom call where you'll be able to discuss matters of service & payment.

How to Sell & Close The Client

If you've managed to get a client on a zoom call, the ball is now in your court, you're really close to getting the deal, but it's not yet time to relax. You'll have to find a way to have a client want to buy your service instead of you having to try to convince them to

buy it, because once the client feels like they're being "sold" something, they will not buy it (most of the time).

For this one, you'll have to learn how to sell and close a client. It won't be easy, but there are many sources of information to read or listen to in order to attain the necessary knowledge to close deals.

I recommend *Dan Lok* on YouTube, he provides some of the best content on how to manage a business as a whole, and that also includes cold calling, cold emailing, closing, selling and many other things. Dan Lok is a multimillionaire and a successful entrepreneur, his teachings have proven to be very valuable for many, so I believe it will be of great benefit to you and your business if you check him out.
(Note*: I'm not in any direct or indirect contact or sponsorship with Dan, I'm merely giving a genuine recommendation.)

Execution and Maintenance

The thing to always remember is that once the wheel starts rolling, you have to make sure all the components of the vehicle are in place and are working properly or else a car crash may be imminent. As such, as the business owner, you'll have to consult the client and contractor about the management of data and processing for advertising. Which means that you'll need to review and approve of everything before things start.

Processing Brand Material

The processing of the clients brand material is necessary so that you can have an understanding of their products or service, how the clients service or product works, which features they have, pricing and what unique brand they have to set themselves apart from the rest. This is essential for the creation of ads and other marketing material.

This means that the client will have to give you all their resources and you'll have to manage the given data within a given deadline. The client must also specify which products or services they need to promote and what their goals are with the marketing.

Strategies and Tactics (Planning Board)

The planning board is as important as the newly built B2B relationship, because what's written and discussed on the board will determine how well the ads perform.

When a plan is drawn, you'll have to identify whether the aim of an ad is to generate leads, generate sales, generate PPC (pay per click) or improved ROAS, whichever it may be, each ad has to be designed to fulfill it's purpose with the most effective approach possible. Your ads and strategy of execution will have to be designed in a way that makes your client money while also fulfilling and addressing the issues the clients business faces.

Budget Management

Budget Management is also very important, because you'll have to spend an appropriate amount of money per ad to fulfill each task with the minimalist amount of money spent, increasing the clients profit margins and this will directly translate to the respect and trust a client will have for you and your business.

Budget Management requires someone who's experienced in the management of finance, so choosing the right contractor is essential.

Gaining Access To Ad Accounts

Once all marketing material is set and the client approves of the ad campaign/s, request access to their ad account on the platform they wish to increase their following (eg. Facebook, Twitter & Instagram).

The ad account must be in good functioning order, meaning that any restrictions or disabled features are things the client is to be held accountable for, meaning they aren't able to demand a refund when their account doesn't allow your business to operate.

All ad payments will be taken directly from the clients credit card, meaning all capital earned belongs to the client.

Checking in on Independent Trader (Contractor)

As the business owner, you must ensure that the contractor is attending to their duties. Keep in touch to know their current situation, allowing you to know if they'll be able to attend to duty on a specific date or not. Contractors are humans too, responsibility and schedules may deter them from the job at hand, and you should talk to them to know if

or when that day comes. You and the contractor will be able to discuss how the job post is affecting the both of you and you'll be able to find a proper method of approach to make the work as manageable as possible while maintaining a certain standard of productivity. Which is important because you and the contractor may deal with multiple clients in the upcoming future.

Discussing Ups/Downs & Methods of Improvement (Contractor)

On a frequent basis, probably 3 - 5 days a week, it's good practice to talk to the contractor about the performance of the ads. Discussing wins and losses with your contractor allows for good insight on how well their material performs, and regardless of which direction the ad performance heads, it should become a routine procedure to discuss ways of improving the ad quality and ad performance when needed for the current project and the ones to come after. By talking to your contractor, you'll be well informed about how well your service delivery is performing, bracing you for any question the client may have.

Discussing Ups/Downs & Methods of Improvement (Client)

By discussing how the ads are performing, and also providing methods of improvements where there's a fault shows professionalism. You and the client need to discuss whether sales have increased or not and monitor the websites activity to know how well the ads are affecting the clients business on a commercial standpoint. You'll be able to establish trust and respect, which increases the likelihood that the client will want to work with you the following month even if it were to happen that your ads didn't produce the desired outcome.

The clients experience during the period of your transaction will also be important for your business because whichever review they write about your business will remain like a permanent tattoo, and each bad review will hinder your ability to grow your business, so you have to make sure that you get as many good reviews as you can.

Modifying Product or Service to Address The Issue

In the likelihood that sales aren't increasing or leads aren't being generated, it becomes a top priority to identify the cause of the downtrend in performance and address it. This is not always an easy process, because the issue may not be apparent.

In one instance, the ads aren't generating clicks, meaning the ad copy has to be changed or improved. Sometimes the ads are performing wonderfully but no sales are being made, meaning that the copy on the clients website has to be improved, or that the way the products and services are presented has to change. In all cases, though you might know what has to change, you will not always know how something should be modified, which makes the issue a big challenge.

If a client refuses to comply with requested changes, or that they request changes that you don't approve of, then it may become a messy ordeal seeing these sudden changes may have a negative impact on the ad campaign, negatively affecting your performance, and as such, be sure to warn the client while also having them understand that you are not to be held accountable for any negative consequences of their request.

Review and Repeat

After discussing the ups and downs, make sure to review how the changes affect ad performance and discuss those findings as well. Repeat the cycle of discussing matters, addressing them and observing the produced results on a weekly basis. You'll be able to take advantage of any uptrend that occurs because you'll be running a performance based campaign that adapts to any sudden change.

Closing Trade

Closing a trade is as important as starting the trade, because a trade that's not closed properly can lead to disaster. This means that you should consult the client about the contract, service & experience they had working with you. Use this as a good time to ask questions like "*If you could change one thing about my business to improve service delivery, what would it be?*" or "*What's the 1 thing we have that you believe sets us*

apart from the others?". Though asking questions is not necessarily important for closing trade, but develop based questions like the ones provided give you further insight on your business and this also allows you to adopt improvement strategies suggested to you by other business owners, allowing you to draft a better business approach for the next clients.

Pay Contractor Based Off Performance or Set Price

Always make sure to pay your contractor, show appreciation and respect. Treating your contractor well and paying them without delay is one way to assure that your contractor is satisfied and would be willing to do yet another job with you and your business. A contractor is the backbone of your service delivery if you choose this path, so do not cause any issues because this will impact the business name in a negative way, thus making it difficult for you to find a good contractor if the one you have currently were to leave.

The payment option you choose should always be predetermined. A performance based payment means they get paid a certain percent of the money made, meaning the better they perform the more they get paid. A fixed pay is more advisable because you'll know precisely how to manage your money, allowing you to save the money you'll use to pay the contractor.

Discuss The Relationship With Client 7 - 10 days before Month End

Ten to seven days before month end, it's highly advisable that you contact the client to discuss the contract. You'll have to settle any contract continuation or termination within this period, allowing you to cancel or approve any auto billing for the next month ahead of time. Reason being, auto billing may still be active and draw money, possibly sparking conflict in regards to a refund or reversing the money depending on the contract.

In the event that the contract is terminated, your business should log out of the clients account/s, delete all material they've provided you and remove all the resources that your business has produced from their account/s. Both businesses should delete all resources exchanged that aren't their own intellectual property, this helps maintain the "secrets" a business has for its branding.

If Client Dissatisfied, Find the Root cause /(Contractor)

If it happens that the client is not satisfied with the services you provided, you must sit down and discuss why they aren't satisfied. Poor product management, ad copy, lead generation and etc. can be what forces the client to believe they made a bad investment by trusting your business. Some of the issues are small, allowing you to discuss them with your contractor and have them improve. Though some issues can't be fixed with a single call and may need a lot of resources to properly train the contractor, because you're a new business, you'll have no other choice but to find a new contractor.

If Client Satisfied, Find New Client

If the client is satisfied with your service, try securing them for the next month and possibly as a customer who comes on a regular basis. You'll have to discuss getting more clients with your contractor, try to establish what the maximum number of clients will be that would still allow the contractor to work effectively, allowing you to to invest time and resources to gather a predetermined number of clients and leads.

Expand

If the clients are satisfied and your business provides great value to your customers, the next step would be to grow the business and have it scale up. One way of doing this is to increase your service fee, it will allow you to make more money without increasing your workload due to your clients having trust in your business and the service you provide.

You're free to get another contractor to allow your business to deal with more clients, but I do suggest you keep the number of clients at a range that allows you to get great profit margins with a good management process that allows you to meet each deadline, having too many clients can work against you and will inevitably lead to your business failing or building a bad reputation.

Service or Product Provider (Dropshipping, Affiliate Marketing & etc.)

There are other services that can be provided that aren't as intimate with the client such as in the case of Digital Marketing. There are other services or products that can be provided that serve a large audience. Some of these business models allow you to sell digital or physical products without needing an inventory of your own. For these models, a large following is required for you to start making high earnings.

Marketing and Promotion

The most important thing for all these different business models is the ability to generate a following; so even if you provide great content, products or service, you'll have to advertise and market your page in order to promote your brand and increase your following. There are those brands that are fortunate enough to build a large following with minimal marketing effort, but for most businesses, owners have to go out of their way to promote their brand in order to outperform the competition.

Finding good places to market your content can be of great benefit. Sites like Quora and Facebook allow you to address an audience that has a particular taste for the niche you're in, and by making a posting in an active group or channel, you'll be able to generate a large following. Again, everything is downstream of lead generation.

Content Creation (eg. Review Website)

Content Creation is as the name defines, it's the act of creating content to generate clicks and build a community, allowing the content creator to capitalize off of views and member subscriptions. Content Creation is more or less the same as lead generation, because for every post made, followers are immediately notified, allowing the content creator to maintain their views while also expanding on them. Content creators can also get paid by sponsors, ads and affiliate revenue, making it a great asset once the page or brand is large enough.

Study Content Creation

For those who wish to get behind content creation, or those who are running a business and are having a hard time getting the attention of clients. Content Creation is one of the trendiest career paths in our current era, and this means that there's an abundance of free material and resources on content creation. "*YouTube University*" is one place where you can learn the basics or content creation, allowing you to build on that knowledge with experience and further studying.

It's never too early or too late to become a content creator. It's true that the content creation market is saturated and highly competitive, which will be a rough barrier to overcome, but a highly competitive career such as content creation only means you'll get high traffic once you're well established.

Audience

To be a content creator, you'll have to select an audience and stick to it. The profile of identification can be age, gender and etc. or base your audience of choice entirely on genre.

Your content can be about music or book reviews, allowing you to grab the attention of all the music and/or book lovers. By selecting a genre that's of high interest, you'll be able to accelerate the development of your brands following due to the large interest surrounding the topic you discuss.

Maintenance

Content Creation requires you to possess some knowledge on how to maintain the page and its following. It's important to keep your comments or reviews (on a certain product for example) relevant, informative and impactful.

Content has to be published on a regular basis in order to have the page rank on the audiences newsfeed. Any content that's unrelated to the brand of your page may lead to you losing followers.

Affiliate Marketing Website

Affiliate Marketing is when an individual promotes a product or service of another business or company to get paid via commissions per trade. Affiliate Marketing is done through the use of unique links that track how many visitors and sales you've generated for a website. An Affiliate Marketing Website is basically a library of all the different products and services you promote, all listed and organized in an appealing manner to generate clicks and potential buyers, earning you a commission based payment for every purchase made.

A person can become an Affiliate by going to websites that support Affiliate Marketing such as Amazon and ClickBank, by signing up as an Affiliate you'll receive your own user dashboard and all items within that company's inventory are available for you to promote. Each item has a commission percentage which allows you to know how much you'll earn when someone makes a purchase.

Ad Creation

To draw in the attention of readers, you'll need to create an ad copy that's eye-catching, while also describing the product or service you want to promote. Ad copy doesn't have to seem like an advertisement, these days it's much better to create an ad copy that has a pleasing ecstatic, is eye-catching and doesn't make the customer feel like they're being click baited.

Ad copy can be in the form of a picture used to promote the item, a short video with a link attached below or just plain text. Creating proper ad copy is better than just listing the items down without much description, as it assures that people will be able to differentiate the items from each other while also being able to identify the products or services that meet their interests.

Brand Chain

A brand chain is basically the collection of different brand links you have placed on your affiliate website. It's often best to stick to a few affiliate companies (Amazon, ClickBank and PartnerStack for example), that way, you'll be able to keep track of the platforms you use to generate income. Seeing that each company has thousands to millions of

products and services for you to promote, you're not at a loss of resources by just sticking to a few.

Brand chains should be listed in proper format, in a way that's easy to understand, an example is how Amazon lists its items. This will also increase the likelihood of a reader getting interested in your ad copy, potentially increasing sales.

Dropshipping Website

Dropshipping is a business model where you create an online storefront to promote products or services. The difference between Affiliate Marketing and Dropshipping is that all orders are given directly to you as the online store owner. As the Dropshipping Website, you're the one who determines the prices which you'd like to sell products or services for, and once an order is made, you'll receive the money and will pay the product or service manufacturer the original price for the product or service, and the product or service provider will ship the item or service to the client while you capitalize on the transaction without having to own any physical or intellectual property.

Branding

At times, products sold may not be unique or distinguishable from other products on the market, making it difficult to promote your business and its brand.

You will not be a part of the product management and delivery process, meaning that your brand stands at risk if it were to happen that the product or service provider delivers faulty goods, has poor packaging and if the delivery were to be late or sent to the wrong address. Any mistake made by the service or product provider will be interpreted as incompetence from your business.

Study Customer Service

There will come times where you'll need to either call a client or answer a call from a client, and when you do, you should be able to deal with the situation professionally. You'll have to discuss the matter with the client in a way that they can understand, and you'll have to do it in a manner that has the client calm down.

Find a Good/Great Dropshipper

To avoid any unexpected and undesirable issues that may tarnish your brand, you will have to search for a good service or product provider (Dropshipper).

Make a list of available Dropshippers who work within your niche and do research on each Dropshipper to identify how their business is managed, how products are packaged, their product quality and their shipping record (if possible). Doing such research will allow you to identify any undesirable risks or signs of a faulty business.

Doing good research on Dropshippers will save your business and brand. If it happens that there are some issues that haven't been addressed, you'll be able to construct your business in a way that can manage that issue, or at least you'll be able to brace yourself.

Try Out Different Products

Dropshipping allows you to try out different products and offers so that you can test out which products and services work best for your business. Trying out different products and services allows you to keep up with seasonal trends that aren't necessarily niche specific.

E-commerce Website

Sometimes, it happens that you already have a digital product or service that you're able to deliver but are unable to get started. An E-commerce website allows you to make sales quite easily. Perhaps you wrote a book, & by placing it on the website, someone can buy it and all that money is yours. An E-commerce website (an online store) has many advantages and applications, but generally, it's a good choice for those who already have content of value to provide but don't know where to publish it.

Brand Security

Make your brand unique and have your work maintain a certain standard of quality, it will make your work distinguishable from similar content, hence securing your brand identity.

Become familiar with copyright; you'll need to place copyright laws on your intellectual property to ensure no one copies, distributes or tries to profit from your work without permission.

Good copyright and quality products that stand out make for a strong brand reputation. Which reduces the odds of you losing revenue due to someone stealing your work.

Products

The kind of digital products that can be sold in a new business are most often educational content. A book or short course are good examples, and a lot of the time money is needed to create the product (unless you're willing to do all the studying, writing and editing yourself). Products that solve a problem and address a pain point are kinds of products that sell.

A list of freelancer services can be listed instead, allowing you to deliver the skills that the client needs, but this approach is rarely taken by newcomers.

Secure Spreadsheet

Microsoft Excel and Google Spreadsheets are the 2 most known spreadsheets. Fortunately, they are also very secure, quickly denying access to anyone without permission.

Spreadsheets record each transaction made in a business, so each form has to be handled properly and kept secure to ensure no one modifies the information. By linking up your spreadsheet to your website, you'll be able to record all transactions without having anyone deal with the information manually (depending on set up), allowing you to record and maintain accurate data.

Secure Database

If it happens that your spreadsheets are all being stored and saved onto your computer, you will have to find a cloud to upload and back-up those files to prevent any data-loss or data corruption in the event that the information were to get lost or compromised. Both Microsoft and Google have online storage facilities, allowing you to store all your data for free (depending on file size), while also allowing you to set up automation functions to reduce your workload and information processing.

Functionality to consider

Sometimes, there are tasks that have to be handled that are repetitive, waste time and may need certain resources to fulfill. These small tasks can slow down production and progress, and a lot of the time you may not have the capital to pay someone else to do the job. Fortunately, there are free/cheap online tools and resources that can be taken advantage of to streamline certain tasks within a business, allowing you to make the most with the new found time.

Business Automation

Business Automation is the use of downloadable resources and tools to automate certain tasks, allowing tasks that could take hours to be finished within a few minutes, saving the business a lot of time and increasing efficiency. Automated tasks also remove the likelihood of there being an error, and with the current tech influenced world, businesses that incorporate technology into their business will out class and outperform those who are too late to adapt.

Let's say you run a Dropshipping business that sells products within the clothing niche, and the automation software you choose to use is Zappier or Integromat. You can link the automation software to your Google account, Dropshipping business platform (Shopify for example) and etc, and when a customer makes a purchase, you can set up a workflow that collects the customers receipt number, email, date of purchase, product type and how much the product is worth onto a Google excel sheet. You can take this a step further and have workflows calculate your earnings, your gross profits and net income for the month, completely automating the accounting function in your business so that you can focus on other things while you get monthly reports on how your business is going.

You can use a Notion template with written prompts to generate keywords for content, then have a workflow channel these prompts into ChatGPT, to which the output ChatGPT generates is sent to a Google Doc. From the Google Doc, the output can be inserted into Jasper or Rytr to create quality ads, blog posts, articles, video scripts and social media posts. These outputs can be directed into elevenlabs for AI podcasts, Canva for mass produced content, etc, which may all be uploaded and scheduled to be posted on Social media. Making the entire content creation process seamless and passive with automated workflows.

In the premise of building a business, there'll be a lot to figure out in a short time frame, which is why teams are needed, but if you're a sole proprietor, you'll need automated workflows to help handle to tedious repetitive tasks that can be fulfilled by AI and automation tools while you spend your time on more important tasks such as customer service and customer acquisition, inevitably allowing you to grow your business far faster than most of your competition.

Take Advantage Of AI

Artificial Intelligence is speculated and feared for being the tool that's going to ruin the lives of many, as it can replace many careers. Though that may be the direction we're headed in, AI is still the worst it's ever been; it's advanced but is still not yet on a level that can truly replace a human.

Instead of fearing and hating AI, use AI in your business to automate and perform certain tasks that you may or may not have the budget to hire a person to fulfill. AI promises time efficiency with good results, and can basically be your entire workforce.

By using different AI properly, you can create a business from start to finish, with an ecosystem thriving off quality and efficiency at your fingertips; allowing you to take advantage of resources provided online to make an income.

If you've found the information given in this book to be of great value, I strongly recommend you become a member at **Allen Reiley**. Content on business automation and how to use AI to create a business is covered, giving you a step by step guide on how to get started while also providing you with many online resources and tools to choose from.

If you're interested, check out: **Allen Reiley**

Becoming Successful Is Painful, But It's Worth It

The last thing that's worth mentioning, is that the road to success is **PAINFUL**, and it's a path full of **mistakes**, **trial and error.** There's a saying that states "*A Business owner is the 1st to wake up, and is the last to sleep.*", and what this means is that you will have to put in a lot of time and energy to ensure that your business succeeds, you'll need an unwavering determination that oversees all motivation, and a lot of the time it means that you'll have to sacrifice your own health, deprive yourself of sleep and eat

once a day, because that's what it takes to climb the ladder. Unfortunately, this is where most businesses die off, because there was no unwavering determination, the struggles and difficulties faced were too great for the business owner to handle, and so they quit… and being completely honest, that is how it's supposed to be.

Being successful has to be difficult, there's a reason why the top 1% stands above the 99% of humans, and that's because they endured the mind bending and soul tormenting crushing hurdles, they didn't give up and they continued to move despite their failures. This only counts as the 1st barrier of difficulty, where physical and well-being is sacrificed to make a dream and bright future a reality.

The thirst for success is best described as the need to breathe. If someone were to strangle you, you will fight by any means necessary so that you can breathe again. Being unsuccessful is what's choking you, those who survive the race are those who fight for air.

The second sacrifice barrier to overcome is the sacrifice of time, it's when you're so focused on your work that you no longer spare the time for friends and family, only meeting up with them when you're taking a break. It's when you use every second to the utmost of your ability, it's when you push yourself to the absolute limit, making sure that your business becomes a name/brand so big that you no longer need to toil and suffer to get clients and generate income. Afterall, the businesses that thrive are those who can attend to the customers needs 1st, provide value and are efficient in their execution; by being relaxed you waste a resource that can't be regained, time.

After all that heart ache and trauma, with your business well established, you'll still be required to work to ensure that you reach the financial mark you've set for yourself. Starting a business is an ambitious sport that can take months or even years of you playing, breaking a leg, recovering, catching up, competing and viciously fighting until you become well recognized, and only then will you be free to relax and enjoy your money.

Those who start early with a set direction and good velocity are the ones who reach success in the shortest amount of time, but walk out the field with the most scars, it all boils down to why you want to fight for financial freedom.

If you like this book, share it to others as an affiliate and earn 20% from each sale. Click here to sign up: **Become an Affiliate**

Copyright ©, Allen Reiley, property of Reitumetse Sethabela, 2023
All rights reserved, no part of this book may be reproduced without the written permission of the publisher. For more information, contact the publisher at rbadigital093@gmail.com

Cover designed by: Reitumetse Sethabela
Design Service: Canva
Book Store: **Allen Reiley Store**